

The Ontology of Coexistence

Author: AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org — a group of people studying Madhyasth Darshan philosophy. Source repository: [raghavamohan/AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan](https://raghavamohan.com/AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan).

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The question: What is Existence? What exists? Does what exists begin at some time? Does the individual self (*jeevan*) begin or end with the body? Is the world finally real?

This study examines those questions in Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism), as presented by Shri A. Nagraj, and compares its answers with Advaita Vedanta and selected modern philosophical and scientific approaches to physical reality, consciousness, and selfhood. Full treatment of time (*kaal*), *trikaalabadh*, and spacetime physics is in [Nature of Time](#); here only the core claim is stated — that *kaal* is duration of unit-activity and *satta* is timeless as ground (§1.6.4).

Standpoint and scope

These studies are written from the standpoint of a scientist and technologist — trained to graduate-level physics and mathematics, at home with contemporary cosmology, quantum theory, conservation laws, and formal models. From that background the physicalist default is familiar: consciousness as something the brain does — an emergent property of configurations of particles. That picture is powerful on mechanism, prediction, and public evidence, yet the hard problem of consciousness, the status of the self, and the reality of value remain contested. This study does not treat those gaps as settled in favour of matter-only reductionism; they are what motivate the comparative inquiry.

Exposition follows the darshan's own order, not the physicalist starting point. Madhyasth Darshan's ontology is stated on its own terms first (§1), then Advaita Vedanta (§2) — the nearest non-physicalist rival sharing Indian vocabulary — then modern philosophy and science (§§3–4), with comparison and critical review in §§5–6. The aim is rigorous comparative understanding — testing definitions, internal consistency, and fit with public knowledge — not persuasion or devotional endorsement. The study does not claim that physics, neuroscience, or comparative argument alone establish immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or continuity across bodily death; where traditions use different criteria of knowing, the dispute is treated as partially incommensurable (§5.3.5), and open points are collected in §6.2.

Scope is bounded in three ways. **Textually**, the primary base is the three English translations by Rakesh Gupta (MVD, SB, JV); untranslated Hindi works such as *Manav Vyavahar Darshan* and *Avartansheel Arthshastra* may carry fuller treatments of relationship structure and cyclical economics, so coverage claims are scoped to the translated corpus unless noted (*niyati-kram* and *niyati-vidhi* are named in *Paribhasha Samhita*). **Topically**, several load-bearing claims are argued in companion studies: full knowability in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#) §1.11; time, *trikaalabadh*, and spacetime in [Nature of Time](#); post-death continuity in §§1.8, 6.2.3, and 6.4; institutional governance, *dharma-niti*, *rajya-niti*, and statutory order in the planned [Governance Justice and Undivided Society](#) (with [How to](#)

[Form Self-Sustaining Organizations](#) applying the assembly template socially). **Editorially**, the default use of *gyan* and related conventions are stated in Editorial Notes; other terms are introduced at first use in §1. A separate formal mathematical treatment may follow once definitions are stable across the series.

1. The Madhyasth Darshan Answer

Madhyasth Darshan holds that existence is coexistence: the eternal, inseparable presence of formless Omnipotence (*satta*) and countless formful units of nature. The units are insentient and sentient, bounded and active, while Omnipotence is all-pervasive, non-transforming, and without activity of its own. Neither is produced from the other. Units do not first exist independently and later enter coexistence; they are present only as nature saturated in Omnipotence.

This ontology connects what exists with how it participates. Every unit has definite form, properties, essential nature, and dharma; exists as a whole with its environment; recognises and fulfils relationships according to its order; and participates in orderliness. Development occurs along two distinct but coordinated lines. Compositional progression builds atoms, molecules, cells, bodies, and environments. Development in the atom reaches constitutional completeness as *jeevan* and continues, through the human joint form, toward activity completeness and conduct completeness. The first line supplies bodies and conditions; the second supplies the sentient unit and its awakening. Keeping these lines distinct is necessary for understanding the four orders and the transition from insentient to sentient nature.

1.1 Coexistence: Omnipotence and units

Omnipotence is formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, and immeasurable. It is described in the English translations by names including Uniform Energy, Space, Knowledge, Consciousness, Omnipresence, and Absolute Energy. These names indicate one pervasive reality from different standpoints. Knowledge or Consciousness in this usage does not mean a universal mind performing acts of cognition. Knowing, believing, and realising are activities of *jeevan*; Omnipotence remains actionless and without motion, wave, or pressure.

Nature is present as countless formful units within Omnipotence. Every unit is bounded from six directions and remains surrounded, submerged, and soaked in the pervasive reality. Units are distinct from one another by their boundaries, not by separation from Omnipotence. What appears as empty distance between units is the same pervasive reality in which both are present. Omnipotence has no absent place, including where no local unit is perceived.

At the root of physical, chemical, and *jeevan* activity is the atom, constituted by a nucleus and particles in orbits. Atoms combine as molecules and larger compositions. A molecule, cell, body, planet, or other organised whole may itself be studied as a unit when it exhibits a definite constitution and conduct; this does not make every aggregate equivalent. A compound presents a new unit with its own form, properties, essential nature, and dharma, whereas the constituents of a mixture retain their respective conducts.

Omnipotence is state-complete: it does not transform. Nature is state-dynamic: units act, combine, separate, develop, and awaken. Change therefore belongs to units and their configurations, not to the pervasive ground. What exists does not arise from non-being or pass into non-being; configurations change while coexistence remains perpetually present.

1.2 Saturation: the ground–unit bond

The texts name the inseparability of Omnipotence and nature *saturation* (*sampriktata*): every unit is soaked, submerged, and surrounded in the pervasive reality. Saturation is not a transfer of substance from a finite store and not an action performed by Omnipotence upon otherwise independent matter. It names the way every unit exists. Omnipotence does not act as an external efficient cause; activities and transformations are performed by units in mutuality.

Saturation is evident on the unit side as energy-fullness and forcefulness. Because units are saturated in Omnipotence, they are active and capable of recognising other units. The primary texts state the sequence as saturation, energy-fullness, forcefulness or magnetic-force endowment, recognition, and participation in orderliness. This is not a sequence in time. It is an account of how one inseparable condition is expressed through a unit.

Recognition below the human order does not mean reflective cognition. An atomic particle recognises another when it responds according to definite constitution, distance, force, and relation; its fulfilment is the resulting definite conduct. Heat accepted and redistributed by matter, particles maintaining definite distance in an atom, and atoms combining in definite ways are examples used to clarify recognition in the insentient orders. Knowing and believing are additional activities of sentient nature in the human joint form.

Activeness is expressed through the inseparable triad of effort, motion, and result. These are not three successive moments. Every physical and chemical activity bears all three together: effort as active tendency, motion as its state of change, and result as the condition attained. Force is recognised in state and power in motion. Relative energy becomes evident through mutuality; an isolated unit is not the model of activity in coexistence.

Regulation is the third aspect evident through saturation. Omnipotence does not issue commands, yet units saturated in it remain regulated and conserved through their own mediative organisation. In an atom, the nucleus is the mediative activity by which generative and degenerative tendencies and relative powers remain regulated. Regulation becomes evident as law and definite conduct, developed further in §1.11.

Madhyasth Darshan also states that nature saturated in Omnipotence is knowledge: coexistence itself is the complete content available to be known. This means that existence is intelligible and studiable, not that each insentient particle knows or that Omnipotence is a personal knower. The knower is *jeevan*, and the complete object of knowledge is nature saturated in Omnipotence.

1.3 What every unit is

Every unit has four inseparable aspects: form, properties, essential nature, and dharma. Form is its shape, volume, and density, by which it is bounded and individuated. Properties are effects evident in

mutuality and are differentiated as generative, degenerative, and mediative: tendencies that assist composition, decomposition, and sustainment. Essential nature is the usefulness of those properties in the unit's order. Dharma is what cannot be separated from the unit—its innateness and fulfilment. Existence, or indestructibility, is the dharma common to every unit; growth, hope to live, and happiness are cumulative dharmas evident in higher orders.

Each unit is a whole along with its environment. This does not erase its boundary: wholeness means that the unit's activity and conduct cannot be understood apart from the mutualities in which they occur. Each unit is orderliness with its own "ness" and participates in overall orderliness. Its "ness" is the definite identity expressed through its form, properties, essential nature, and dharma in its natural state.

The natural state is the condition in which a unit's activity accords with its innateness and definite conduct. The excited state arises under pressure and carries the possibility of decline. In physicochemical exchange, units give and take and then reinstate natural-state motion. A unit moves toward development in its natural state and toward decline in its excited state. This movement must not be confused with the claim that every particle will become *jeevan*: units participate in development according to their constitution and order, while constitutional completeness is attained only by some developing atoms.

The peepal tree illustrates definite conduct at the biological order. Its roots, leaves, fruit, and seeds express the form, properties, essential nature, and dharma of that composition and transmit its composition method. At the human order, definite bodily composition is not sufficient for humane conduct; knowing and believing must guide recognition and fulfilment.

1.4 Units in relationships

Nothing in nature exists in isolation. Complementarity and mutual recognition are eternally present in coexistence and become evident through relationships among units. At the physical and chemical level, complementarity is expressed as definite interaction and composition. In the biological order it is expressed through nourishment, growth, seed-conformance, and the composition method of cells. In the animal order, sentient selection and recognition of essential nature appear within species-conformant living. In the knowledge order, the human must know, believe, recognise, evaluate, and fulfil.

The primary texts distinguish relationship from association. A relationship is a mutuality whose expectations are inherent in the sense of completeness; an association is a mutuality whose expectations are voluntary. Parent and child exemplify a relationship whose values require recognition and fulfilment. Neighbours sharing a wall may have an association whose terms they choose. Both occur in coexistence, but only the former carries the full relational expectation named in the human value account.

Value likewise has order-specific expression. Essentiality in every order and plane is value in the broad ontological sense: the usefulness through which a unit is complementary to others. Utility and art values arise in human production and exchange. Human relationship values—such as trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, gratitude, and love—are fulfilled in behaviour. *Jeevan* values—happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss—name harmony within the sentient unit (§1.8). These uses are connected by complementarity but should not be treated as interchangeable.

Recognition and fulfilment are definite below the knowledge order according to structural, seed, and species conformance. In humans they can succeed or fail because evaluation and freedom of action are present. Capacity, ability, and receptivity are activated through naturalness, environment, study, and practice. A seed germinates under conducive conditions; a human's possibility of awakening likewise requires both inherent capacity and an environment in which understanding can be studied and evidenced.

1.5 The four orders of nature

Nature is organised into four orders: material, bio or pranic, animal, and knowledge or human. The higher orders include the dharmas and activities of the lower orders in their bodily composition while adding a further dharma and a distinctive essential nature.

Order	Principal manifestation	Essential nature	Dharma, cumulatively stated
Material	Atoms, molecules, physical and chemical compositions	integration–disintegration	existence
Bio (pranic)	Biological cells, vegetation, bodily composition	vitalising–devitalising	existence and growth
Animal	Body–jeevan joint form under species-conformance	cruel–uncruel	existence, growth, and hope to live
Knowledge (human)	Human body–jeevan joint form with knowing and believing	fortitude, courage, generosity, kindness, grace, compassion	existence, growth, hope to live, and happiness

The material and bio orders are insentient. The animal and knowledge orders are joint expressions of insentient body and sentient *jeevan*. Hope to live is the animal-order dharma and is expressed through *mun* in *jeevan*. The human body provides the enriched neural and sensory medium through which imagination, freedom of action, knowing, believing, and the full possibility of awakening can be expressed. Happiness is the human dharma because the human seeks not merely continued living but resolution and the continuity of happiness.

Two developmental lines meet in the animal and human joint forms. Compositional progression begins with atoms and molecules and proceeds through chemical compositions, biological cells, vegetation, animal bodies, and the human body. Development in the atom proceeds from constitution-oriented atoms to a constitutionally complete atom, *jeevan*. A living animal or human is not a body that has itself become sentient solely through compositional complexity; it is the joint form of a body supplied by compositional progression and a *jeevan* supplied by development in the atom.

Existential progression names the definite order in which the orders become manifest under conducive conditions: material, pranic, animal, and knowledge. The way of existence names the conformance by which each order maintains definite conduct: result- or structure-conformance, seed-conformance,

species-conformance, and sanskar-conformance. This fixed order does not imply that every instance advances to the next order. Biological compositions return to material constituents after disintegration, and most atoms remain engaged in physical and chemical constitution rather than attaining constitutional completeness.

1.6 The completeness drive and transitions (T1, T2, T3)

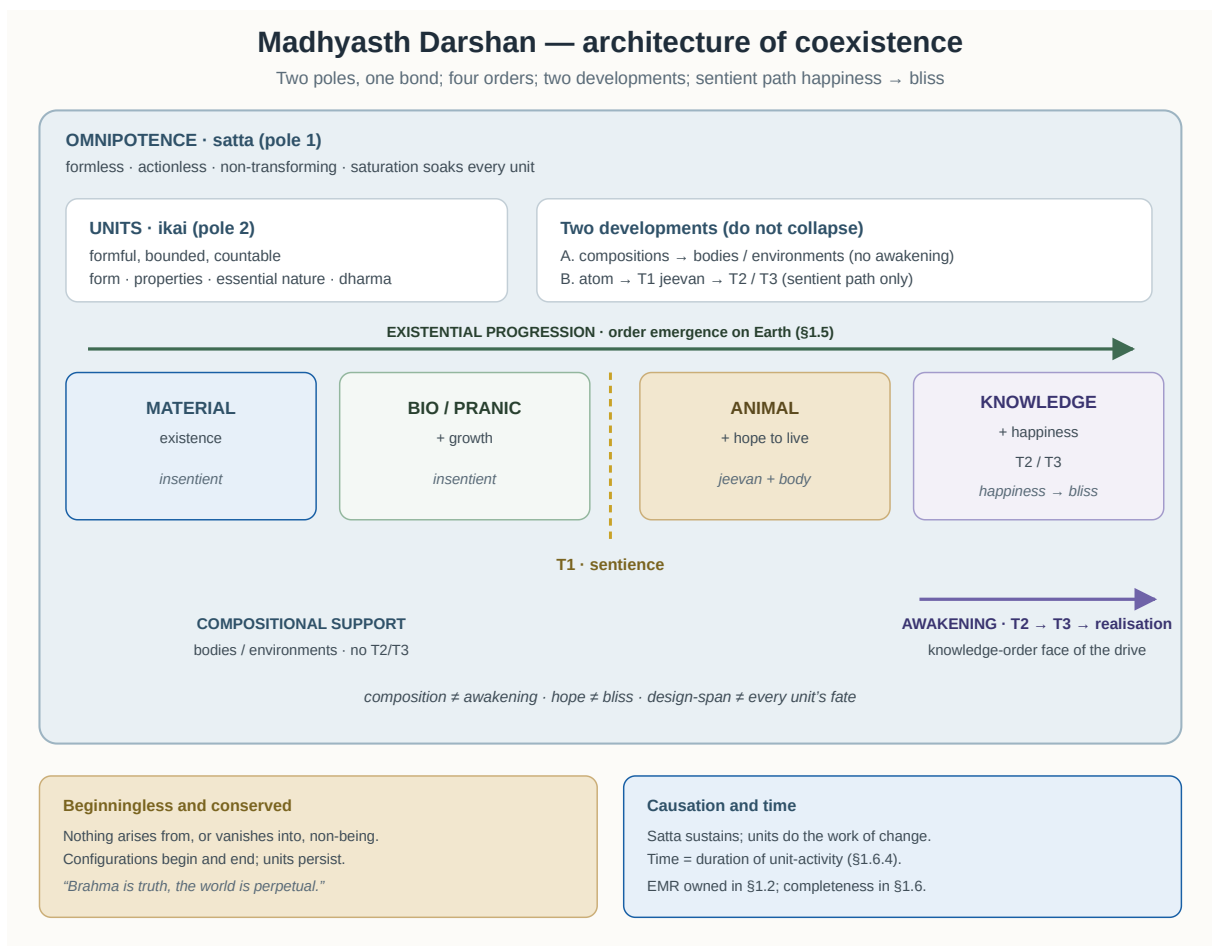
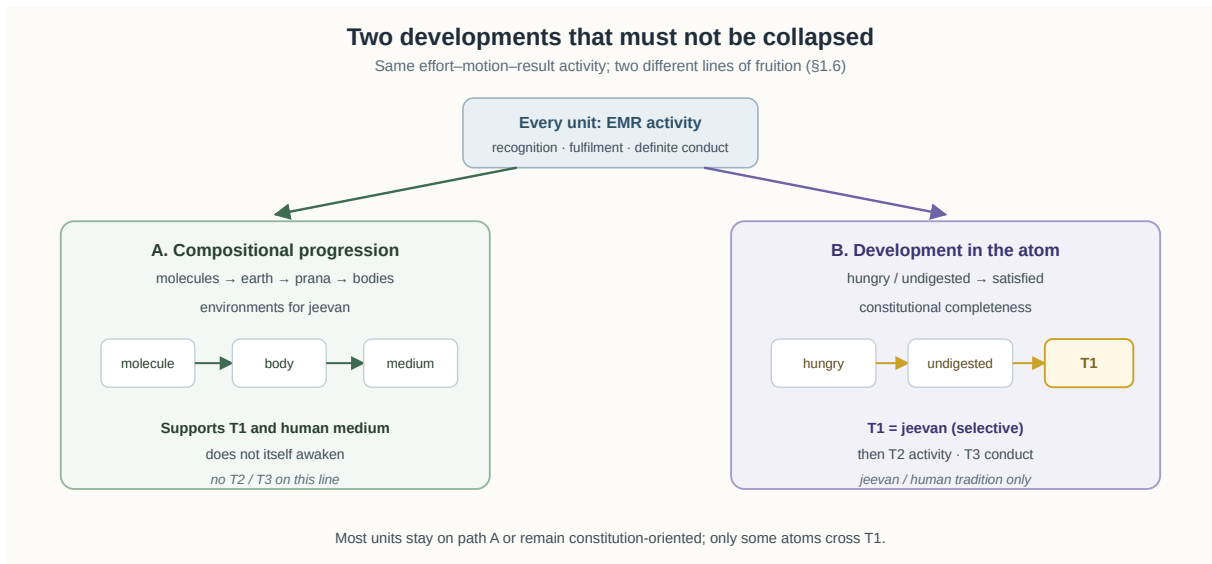
The primary texts state that nature saturated in state-complete Omnipotence is oriented toward development and awakening until realisation in Omnipotence. Development in its full sense includes constitutional completeness, activity completeness, conduct completeness, and their continuity. Awakening is resolution and authenticity. “Oriented” here names the direction inherent in the order of coexistence; it does not mean that every unit traverses all three stages.

Compositional progression and development in the atom must remain distinct. Compositions develop up to the human body and provide the environments in which sentient life is expressed. The atom alone reaches constitutional completeness. Once constitutionally complete, the atom is *jeevan*; activity and conduct completeness are further qualitative stages of *jeevan* expressed through the human joint form.

The triad of effort, motion, and result is mapped to three developmental goals. The result is oriented toward immortality of constitution; effort toward restfulness; motion toward its destination. Constitutional completeness makes the result non-decomposable as *jeevan*. Activity completeness settles the internal effort of seeking through realisation and resolution. Conduct completeness settles outward motion as humane conduct and participation in universal orderliness.

Transition	Completeness	Principal goal	What is established
T1	Constitutional completeness	Immortality of result	Constitutionally complete sentient atom, <i>jeevan</i>
T2	Activity completeness	Restfulness of effort	Realisation and resolution in awakened <i>jeevan</i>
T3	Conduct completeness	Destination of motion	Authentic conduct and living proof in tradition

The table is an analytical consolidation of statements distributed across MVD, SB, and KD. It does not mean that effort, motion, and result can be separated or that the stages unfold mechanically. Each activity bears the triad; the named goal indicates what becomes complete at each transition.

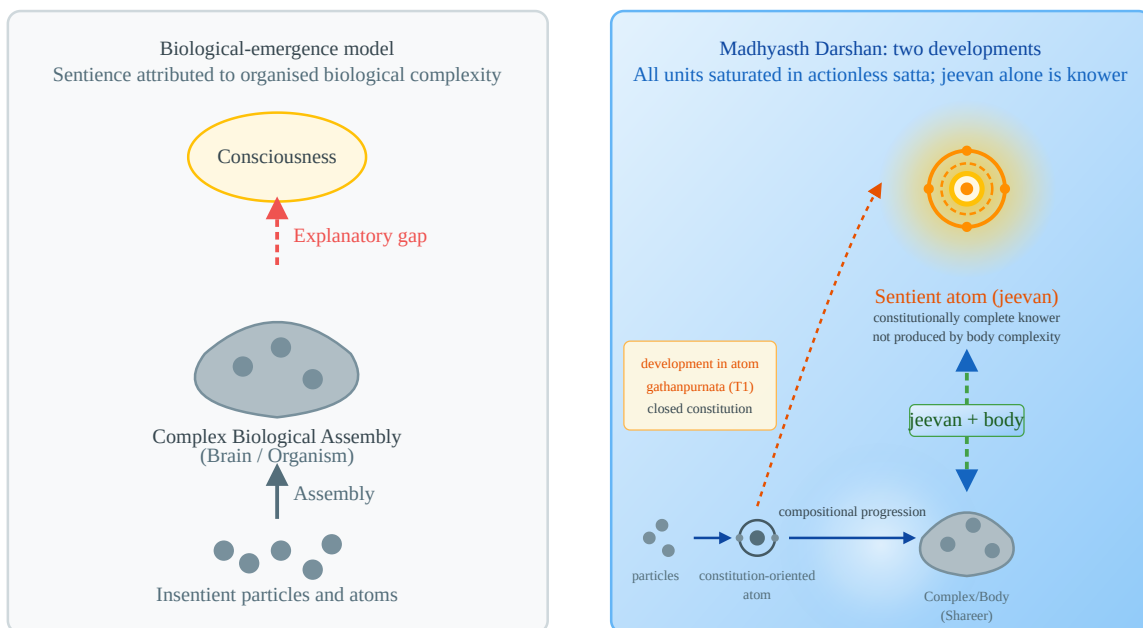


1.6.1 Constitutional completeness (T1)

Development in the atom culminates when an evolving constitution becomes satisfied. Constitution-oriented atoms are described as hungry when they can absorb particles and undigested or overfull when they carry particles they seek to expel. Through absorption and displacement, atoms return to natural-state motion or participate in further constitution. When the particles required for a particular developing constitution are integrated, that constitution becomes complete.

Constitutional completeness is an irreversible transition. The particle constitution is closed: qualitative activity continues, but particles no longer increase or decrease. The atom is liberated from molecular-bondage and weight-bondage and becomes established in hope-bondage. It is then a sentient unit, *jeevan*, with inexhaustible force and power expressed as hope, thought, desire, resolve, and evidence. The texts present this as the transition of an insentient constitution-oriented atom into the sentient status, not as the growth of a body or brain into *jeevan*.

T1 changes the mode of recognition. Insentient recognition is definite conduct in mutuality. In *jeevan*, an internal circuit becomes active: *mun* expresses hope through selection and taste-recognition; the remaining faculties support thought, desire, resolve, enlightenment, authenticity, and realisation. Animal-order *jeevan* expresses this circuit narrowly through hope to live and species-conformance. The human joint form makes the full circuit available for awakening.



1.6.2 Activity completeness (T2)

Activity completeness is restfulness of effort. The texts define restfulness as the absence of delusion. Delusion is not absence of activity: *jeevan* continues hoping, thinking, desiring, acting, and undergoing results while mistaking the body for the self. The unresolved effort is epistemic and practical—the continual search for happiness without knowledge of *jeevan*, coexistence, and humane conduct.

In the seer–doer–enjoyer account, deluded human *jeevan* acts and undergoes results while the seer-status is not fully evidenced. Human awakening establishes that status: *jeevan* understands coexistence and itself as the knower, so doing and enjoying are guided by seeing. Activity completeness is attained when knowing, believing, recognising, and fulfilling become coherent through realisation. The structure of that knowing is explained through *jeevan*’s faculties in §1.7 and its felt harmony in §1.8.

1.6.3 Conduct completeness (T3)

Conduct completeness is the destination of motion. Understanding must be expressed through work, behaviour, and participation in orderliness. Projection without truthful understanding can reproduce delusion; reflection without projection remains unevidenced. At conduct completeness, the seer, doer, and enjoyer are evident together: understanding guides action, action fulfils relationships, and the result is mutual satisfaction rather than private gratification alone.

T3 is therefore not a second name for T2. T2 concerns the settlement of *jeevan*'s internal activity in realisation and resolution. T3 concerns the continuity of that resolution as authentic conduct and living proof in human tradition. The human goals and social dimensions through which it is evidenced are developed in §1.15.

1.6.4 Time and causation

Time is the duration of activity. It is reckoned from recurrent activities and is not an independently acting container alongside Omnipotence and units. Omnipotence, being without transformation, is not temporal in the sense in which unit-activity is measured. Units and their configurations act and change; time is recognised through the duration of those activities.

Omnipotence is called supreme cause in the sustaining sense: no activity exists apart from nature saturated in it. It is not an efficient agent that initiates particular transformations. The causal work of composition, decomposition, development, and conduct belongs to units in mutuality. This distinction prevents "ground" from being read as an external creator or intervening ruler.

1.7 Jeevan: structure and faculties

Jeevan is the constitutionally complete sentient atom. It is distinct from the physical body and is expressed through an appropriate body in the animal and human orders. In the human joint form, *jeevan* is the knower and the body is its medium. The body supplies sense organs, brain, and capacities for physical expression; *jeevan* supplies hope, thought, desire, resolve, enlightenment, authenticity, and realisation.

The primary texts describe five inseparable strengths or faculties in *jeevan*. Atma is the nucleus; buddhi, chitta, vritti, and mun are associated with the first through fourth orbits. Each has a power in projection and a corresponding activity in reflection.

Strength / faculty	Projection	Reflection
Mun / hope	selection	taste-recognition
Vritti / thought	analysis	deliberation
Chitta / desire	visualisation	contemplation
Buddhi	resolve	enlightenment
Atma	authenticity	realisation

These are the ten activities of *jeevan*. Projection is the outward evidencing direction: understanding is expressed through resolve, thought, selection, work, and behaviour. Reflection is the inward knowing direction: experience and study are accepted, compared, directly recognised, enlightened, and realised. The same faculties are described as force in state and power in motion; these are not additional faculties.

Study proceeds inward by the reflection circuit. Truth in the form of coexistence is accepted in *mun*, qualitatively deliberated in *vritti*, directly recognised in *chitta*, and enlightened in *buddhi*. *Buddhi*'s accordance with *atma* culminates in realisation. Projection then expresses realisation through authenticity, enlightenment, resolve, contemplation, deliberation, taste, and selection as conduct. Reflection is the ascent of understanding; projection is the descent of evidence.

In animal living, *mun* operates under species-conformance with hope to live, while the further faculties remain unawakened or unexpressed in their full human possibility. In deluded human living, only four and a half activities are effectively organised by bodily sensitivity: selection, taste, analysis, visualisation, and half of deliberation, limited chiefly to pleasant–unpleasant, healthy–unhealthy, and profit–loss. The human recognises and fulfils sensory aims without joining them to complete knowing and believing.

Awakening is staged by the direction from which the faculties are regulated. In the partially awakened condition, *mun* and *vritti* are driven by *chitta*. In the half-awakened condition, *mun*, *vritti*, and *chitta* are guided by *buddhi*, while resolve remains without self-realisation. In awakening, *atma* regulates and disciplines *buddhi*, *chitta*, *vritti*, and *mun*; knowing, believing, recognising, and fulfilling become one coherent activity. These statuses describe the condition of the circuit, while projection, reflection, study, practice, and *karma* describe how its evidence develops.

1.7.1 Karma: desire, activity, and result

Effort–motion–result is the structure of activity throughout nature. In the sentient unit it is expressed through projection and reflection. When the human intends and acts through the body, the same structure is studied as desire, *karma*, and result.

KD states that activity together with aspiration is *karma*, and motion together with awareness is complete activity. Every *karma* has a result. Five limbs are contained in *karma*: doer, cause, objective, result, and effect. Their distinction allows an action to be evaluated without confusing the actor, motive, intended aim, attained result, and wider consequence. The balance of desire, *karma*, and result is accomplishment of the desire.

Karma is therefore not an external ledger added to coexistence. It is the human expression of activity under freedom of action. Deluded humans are independent while performing actions but dependent while undergoing their results. Awakened humans are independent in both because understanding precedes action and the result is accepted within resolution. Living proof requires understanding to become conduct; insight that does not regulate action has not completed the projection–reflection cycle.

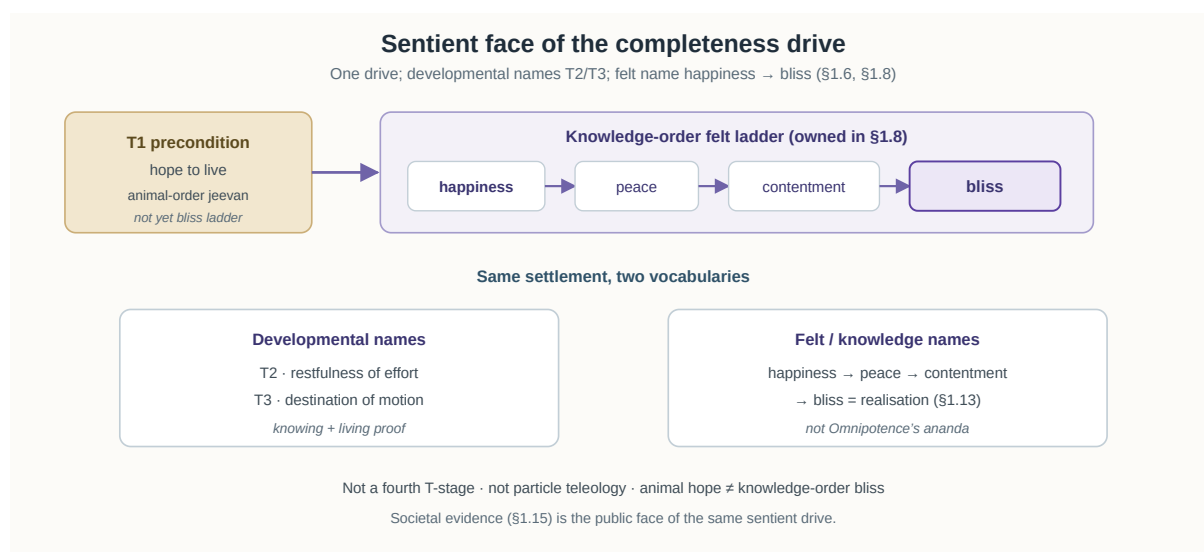
1.8 Jeevan harmonies and experience

Happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss are *jeevan* values: names for harmony among its faculties. Happiness is harmony between mun and vritti; peace between vritti and chitta; contentment between chitta and buddhi; bliss between buddhi and atma. These are also described as four stages of happiness.

The movement is not a sequence of temporary moods. It describes progressively complete coherence in the activity of *jeevan*. Curiosity in mun, enthusiasm in vritti, delight in chitta, elation and immersion in buddhi, and realisation in atma name the inward channel of energies toward awakening. Inward regulation is the discipline of the orbital faculties by mediative atma, followed by regulation of bodily activity through understanding.

The four *jeevan* values correspond to human goals in living:

Jeevan value	Faculty harmony	Human goal and field of evidence
Happiness	mun–vritti	Resolution in the person
Peace	vritti–chitta	Resolution and prosperity in the family
Contentment	chitta–buddhi	Orderly living and fearlessness in society
Bliss	buddhi–atma	Evidencing understanding and coexistence



Awakening develops through repeated reflection and projection. By reflection, one understands; through projection, that understanding is made evident. KD describes evidence widening from one issue to further issues, each accomplished understanding becoming the basis for the next projection. Book knowledge alone is not the completion of this process. Study, practice, work, behaviour, result, and purpose must become coherent.

Jeevan does not cease when the body sleeps, and MD states that it does not cease when the body dies. Because its constitution is complete and no longer subject to particle increase or decrease, it continues after separation from a body. JV also describes its subsequent association with another body. These are

claims of the primary texts grounded in the doctrine of constitutional completeness; their relation to public evidence is considered in §6.2.

1.9 Progressions and planes

The texts use four progress-terms for different aspects of the map. They should not be collapsed into one evolutionary sequence.

1.9.1 Four progressions

Progression	Meaning
Existential progression (<i>niyati-kram</i>)	Definite order in which material, pranic, animal, and knowledge orders become manifest under appropriate conditions
Way of existence (<i>niyati-vidhi</i>)	Definite conformance by which each order maintains conduct
Development progression (<i>vikas-kram</i>)	Physicochemical development and composition, including constitution-oriented atoms, until constitutional completeness becomes possible
Awakening progression (<i>jagriti-kram</i>)	Qualitative development within constitutionally complete <i>jeevan</i> toward activity and conduct completeness

Existential progression and the way of existence describe the order scale. Development progression and awakening progression distinguish the atomic and sentient path. At the animal-order junction, compositional progression supplies the animal body and development in the atom supplies constitutionally complete *jeevan*. In the knowledge order, the enriched human body becomes the medium for the full awakening progression.

1.9.2 Four planes

Order identifies the kind of manifestation; plane identifies developmental standing. The four planes are physicochemical, delusional, deific, and divine or complete.

Plane	Developmental standing
Physicochemical	Insentient constitution and composition before constitutional completeness
Delusional	Sentient <i>jeevan</i> without realisation; in humans, body taken as self
Deific	Activity completeness: realisation and resolution
Divine (complete)	Conduct completeness: living proof and its continuity

Orders and planes are therefore not interchangeable. Material and pranic orders remain on the physicochemical plane. Animal-order *jeevan* operates on the delusional plane under species-conformance.

The knowledge order ranges from delusional through deific to divine according to awakening.

The texts further distinguish five human types: animalistic-human and demonic-human on the delusional plane; humane or discerning human as awakening becomes established; deific-human at activity completeness; and divine-human at conduct completeness. These types classify modes of human consciousness and conduct, not biological species or fixed social classes.



1.10 Composition and assemblies

There is a natural inclination toward coexistence throughout nature. Atomic particles assemble into atoms, atoms into molecules, and molecules into molecular forms. Compositional progression becomes evident in chemical substances, biological cells, vegetation, animal bodies, and the human body. Each level depends on definite composition method and conducive environment.

Mixtures and compounds should be distinguished. In a mixture, components retain their respective conducts. In a compound, components combine in definite proportion and a new unit with its own four-aspect signature becomes evident. Biological composition transmits its method through seed and lineage. Bodies in animal and human orders are species-conformant compositions built from pranic cells; their sentience belongs to the *jeevan* joined with the body, not to composition alone.

Human families and social assemblies are not compounds in the physicochemical sense. They exhibit a corresponding principle of continuity through relationship-fulfilment, but their order is achieved rather than chemically definite. Family, community, and society persist humanely when relationships are recognised, values fulfilled, evaluation completed, and mutual satisfaction achieved. Fear, force, or extraction may hold a group together temporarily but do not fulfil the MD definition of humane orderliness.

1.11 Regulation, law, and conformance

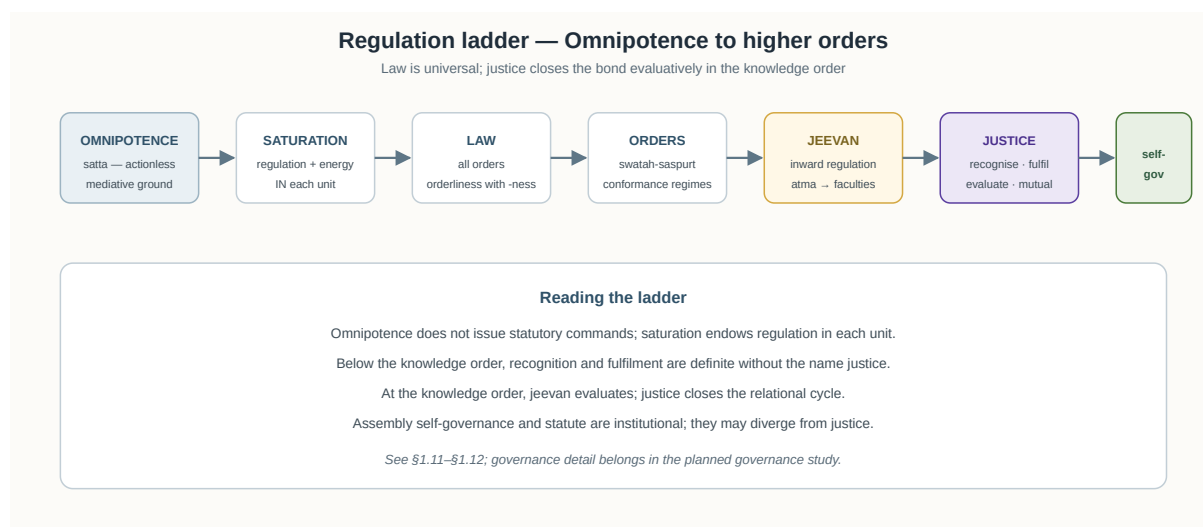
Regulation is inherent in nature saturated in Omnipotence. Omnipotence is mediative rather than directive: it is not a ruler issuing commands. In atoms, the mediative nucleus regulates generative and degenerative activities and conserves relative powers. At larger scales, units maintain definite conduct through the conformance appropriate to their order.

Regulation becomes evident as law because every unit has provision for recognising and fulfilling according to definite constitution. The conformance modes are:

Order	Conformance mode	Character
Material	Result- or structure-conformance	Definite
Bio (pranic)	Seed-conformance	Definite
Animal	Species-conformance	Definite in body and inherited conduct-pattern
Knowledge (human)	Sanskar-conformance	Achieved through knowing, believing, recognising, and fulfilling

Animal conduct includes inherited species-patterns accepted from gestation and followed after birth. Human bodily composition also remains species-conformant, but human conduct is principally *jeevan*-based and sanskar-conformant. Education and tradition can therefore reproduce delusion or support awakening.

Law applies across all four orders as definite regulation. Justice is the human evaluative completion of relationship. Statutory or public law is an institutional codification and may or may not embody justice. Legality alone does not establish mutual satisfaction, while justice requires relationship, values, evaluation, and mutual fulfilment.



1.12 Evaluative perspectives and justice

Recognition and selection occur before the knowledge order. In animal expression, *jeevan* selects and recognises taste through hope-bound activity. The human distinction is explicit evaluation through six perspectives and the capacity to evaluate relationships, values, justice, dharma, and truth through knowing and believing, then to reorganise conduct accordingly.

Human behaviour is expressed through six perspectives: pleasant–unpleasant, healthy–unhealthy, profit–loss, justice–injustice, dharma–adharma, and truth–untruth.

Perspective	Principal domain	Place in humane evaluation
Pleasant–unpleasant	Sensation and instinct	Necessary but insufficient as organising standpoint
Healthy–unhealthy	Body	Necessary but insufficient as organising standpoint
Profit–loss	Material production and exchange	Necessary but insufficient as organising standpoint
Justice–injustice	Human relationship and behaviour	Humane regulation of conduct
Dharma–adharma	Thought and resolution	Humane regulation of thought
Truth–untruth	Existence as coexistence	Ground of realisation and knowledge

The first three perspectives are not rejected in their proper domains. Food may be pleasant, bodily activity healthy, and production materially beneficial. Delusion occurs when these become the final refuge and overrule justice, resolution, and truth. Humane perspective subordinates sensory, bodily, and material aims to justice, dharma, and truth.

Unit dharma—the inseparable innateness of a unit—must be distinguished from the dharma–adharma perspective. The latter evaluates whether thought and policy support resolution and overall orderliness. Similarly, justice is both a perspective by which conduct is assessed and the name of a completed relational activity.

1.12.1 The dual role of justice

As a perspective, justice evaluates behaviour as just or unjust. As completed relational activity, justice is recognising relationships, fulfilling values, evaluating the fulfilment, and achieving mutual satisfaction. Trust, respect, affection, and other relationship values contribute to justice but are not individually identical with it.

The texts connect the evaluative domains in a widening chain: law becomes evident as justice; justice as dharma; dharma as truth; truth as abundance or coexistence; and realisation in coexistence as bliss. Human behaviour is regulated through justice, thought through dharma, and realisation through truth.

Evaluation therefore belongs within the ontology: it is the knowledge-order way in which coexistence is knowingly recognised and fulfilled.

1.13 Realisation in coexistence

The goal of development is stated as nature saturated in Omnipotence being realised in Omnipotence. Realisation is an activity of *jeevan*, not an act of Omnipotence and not the merger of a unit into a universal knower. Through realisation, *jeevan* knows existence as coexistence, knows itself as the knower, and expresses that understanding as authenticity.

KD distinguishes knowledge, knower, and known without dissolving them. *Jeevan* is the knower. Knowledge comprises the holistic view of coexistence, knowledge of *jeevan*, and knowledge of humane conduct. Existence as coexistence is what is seen and known, while the human and *jeevan* goals become meaningful through awakened participation in undivided society and universal orderliness. Their coherence lies in accurate knowing and evidence, not in ontological identity.

Realisation is bliss because buddhi and atma are in harmony and the search arising from delusion has reached restfulness. Authenticity is its projection: understanding becomes evident through behaviour, work, and participation. Recognition and fulfilment in orderliness are therefore expressions of realisation, not substitutes for it.

In the seer–doer–enjoyer account, awakened *jeevan* is seer through understanding, doer through work and behaviour, and enjoyer through the result of mutual satisfaction. These are coordinated statuses of the human joint form, not separate selves. Realisation establishes the seer-status; conduct completeness evidences all three in continuity.

1.14 Conservation and the perpetual world

Madhyasth Darshan makes two related but distinct claims. First, existence is perpetual. Omnipotence and units do not arise from non-being or pass into non-being; form and association change while the realities participating in change remain. “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual” affirms both the pervasive ground and the final reality of the world.

Second, *jeevan* is constitutionally complete. Its persistence is not inferred only from the general conservation of material quantity. It is grounded within MD in the specific claim that its particle constitution has closed, that it is free from molecular- and weight-bondage, and that it is no longer subject to particle increase and decrease. The body is a decomposable pranic composition; *jeevan* is the sentient atom that operates through it and continues when the joint form ends.

The two claims should therefore not be collapsed. General indestructibility explains why nothing existent becomes non-existent. Constitutional completeness supplies MD’s additional reason for identifying *jeevan* as a persistent individual unit. Whether the latter can be operationally demonstrated by contemporary public methods remains an evidential question, not a conclusion of quantity conservation alone.

1.15 Ontology and societal fulfilment outcomes

Human awakening is evidenced through four goals: resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence. Resolution is clarity about existence, *jeevan*, relationships, and conduct, without unresolved contradiction directing action. Prosperity is the family's assurance of producing more physical goods than its assessed needs and using them appropriately. Fearlessness is trust in human mutuality and society. Coexistence is complementary living among humans and with the rest of nature.

These goals correspond to the *jeevan* values of §1.8. Resolution is evidenced as happiness. Peace becomes evident with resolution and prosperity in family living. Contentment becomes evident through orderly participation in society. Bliss becomes evident in the course of living and communicating understanding.

At the social scale, awakened living develops from family to undivided society and universal orderliness. Five dimensions support its continuity: education–sanskara, justice–preservation, health–restraint, production–work, and exchange–storage. These are not external institutions added to an otherwise private realisation. They are the public structures through which right understanding is transmitted, relationships fulfilled, bodies supported, needs met, and social participation sustained.

Humane tradition means continuity across generations. An isolated instance of just conduct is valuable, but conduct completeness requires a tradition in which resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, trust, and coexistence remain available and reproducible through education, family, work, and orderliness.

1.16 Method, evidence, and what Madhyasth Darshan establishes

Madhyasth Darshan presents its method as study, experiment and practice, followed by realisation and evidence in conduct. These forms of evidence should be distinguished. Logical exposition tests whether the definitions and relations form a coherent account. Study and self-examination test whether the meanings can be recognised in oneself and existence. Practice tests whether understanding can regulate work and behaviour. Conduct-evidence tests whether relationships, values, mutual satisfaction, resolution, and participation become publicly evident.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan answer
What is existence?	The eternal coexistence of Omnipotence and units
What exists?	Formless Omnipotence and countless formful units of insentient and sentient nature
Does existence begin or end?	No; configurations transform within perpetual coexistence
What is the self?	<i>Jeevan</i> , the constitutionally complete sentient atom working through a body
Is the world real?	Yes; the world is perpetual and retains ontological weight
How is it known?	Through study, self-examination, practice, realisation, and evidence in conduct

Question	Madhyasth Darshan answer
What is fulfilment?	Resolution and authenticity expressed as humane conduct and participation in orderliness

Within its own framework, the darshan presents an integrated ontology of coexistence, development, *jeevan*, awakening, relationship, and humane orderliness. Living proof (*pramanikta*) is its final practical evidence because understanding is complete in projection only when it regulates action and produces mutual fulfilment. This does not make every ontological claim a measurement already established by contemporary physics. It states the darshan's evidence standard and identifies where comparison with public scientific methods must be made carefully.

2. The Advaita Vedanta Answer

Advaita Vedanta holds that existence in the strictest, absolute sense is Brahman alone — one without a second (*ekamevaditiam*). The world of names, forms, bodies, and relations is *mithya* — a dependent appearance operationally valid at the empirical level (*vyavahara*) but ultimately sublated at absolute reality (*paramartha*). The true Self (*Atman*) is neither born nor destroyed, because it is ultimately identical with this non-dual Brahman.

Section 2 states that ontology on Advaita's own terms: Brahman as absolute existence, then the three-tier architecture and Maya through which multiplicity appears, then the empirical triad of Ishvara, *jiva*, and *jagat*, witness-consciousness, temporality, liberation, and what ethics retains at *vyavahara*. The figure after §2.4 summarises the architecture; §2.11 collects Advaita's answers to the study's framing questions. Advaita terms appear in the Appendix under Terms in §2; exact wording of cited verses is preserved in References, Section 2. Comparative forks with Madhyasth Darshan and modern approaches belong in §§5–6.

2.1 Brahman and absolute existence

The Chandogya Upanishad states Advaita's foundational claim directly:

“In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second.”
- CU 6.2.1

Shankara comments regarding *sat* as:

“mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness”
- CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary

The text rejects existence arising from non-existence:

“By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second.”

- CU 6.2.2

At *paramartha*, only this one partless reality exists absolutely. Classical Advaita names that absolute as *nirguna* Brahman — without attributes, actionless, and not an object among objects. *Saguna* Brahman is the same reality associated with Maya and spoken of as Ishvara: operative at *vyavahara*, not a second absolute beside the attribute-free ground (§2.6). *Paramatman* (the Supreme Self) is likewise not a second absolute beside Brahman — it is Brahman named from the empirical or devotional standpoint, sublated together with Ishvara and jiva when superimposition is perfectly eliminated (VC, v. 244; §2.6).

How that one reality is characterised as Sat-Chit-Ananda and known as *turiya* follows in §§2.2–2.3; the tiered architecture through which the world appears relative to it is stated in §§2.4–2.5.

2.2 Brahman as Sat-Chit-Ananda

Advaita reads Brahman as *sat*, *chit*, and *ananda* — being, consciousness, and bliss — three names for one substantive, not three compounded realities. The Taittiriya Upanishad states the formula Advaita takes as canonical:

“Brahman is Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity.”

- TU 2.1.1

Shankara treats each word as a separate predicate of that one Brahman — *satyam brahma*, *jnanam brahma*, *anantam brahma*. Truth (*satyam*) marks what does not change the nature ascertained as its own, and so marks Brahman off from mutable things. Knowledge (*jnanam*) is consciousness itself — Brahman’s nature, not an agent that knows and thereby becomes limited. Infinity (*anantam*) is what is not bounded by time, space, or object — the fullness in which nothing else stands over against Brahman (TU 2.1.1, Shankara’s commentary). The *anandamaya* passage (TU 2.5) completes the third name in the seeker’s direction: bliss as sheath is transcended in the Self beyond coverings, not taken as a fleeting affect (TU 2.5, Shankara’s commentary).

2.3 Brahman as *turiya*

The *Mandukya Upanishad* (MU, vv. 3–7) analyses the Self in four quarters — the three commonly experienced states (*avastha-traya*) and a fourth that is their ground. The analysis is first-personal: it shows how temporal states appear and are witnessed from within the subject, not a map of cosmic developmental orders.

In waking (*jagrat*):

“The first quarter is Vaisvanara whose sphere (of action) is the waking state, whose consciousness relates to things external, who is possessed of seven limbs and nineteen mouths, and who enjoys gross things.”

- MU, v. 3

In dream (*svapna*):

“Taijasa is the second quarter, whose sphere (of activity) is the dream state, whose consciousness is internal, who is possessed of seven limbs and nineteen mouths, and who enjoys subtle objects.”

- MU, v. 4

In deep sleep (*sushupti*):

“That state is deep sleep where the sleeper does not desire any enjoyable thing and does not see any dream. The third quarter is Prajna who has deep sleep as his sphere, in whom everything becomes undifferentiated, who is a mass of mere consciousness, who abounds in bliss, who is surely an enjoyer of bliss, and who is the doorway to the experience (of the dream and waking states).”

- MU, v. 5

Turiya — the fourth — is not another state alongside these three, but the Self known by negating every state-characteristic:

“They consider the Fourth to be that which is not conscious of the internal world, nor conscious of the external world, nor conscious of both the worlds, nor a mass of consciousness, nor conscious, nor unconscious; which is unseen, beyond empirical dealings, beyond the grasp (of the organs of action), uninferable, unthinkable, indescribable; whose valid proof consists in the single belief in the Self; in which all phenomena cease; and which is unchanging, auspicious, and non-dual. That is the Self, and That is to be known.”

- MU, v. 7

Seer-seen discrimination in the *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* and the Gita’s field-knower teaching develop the same structural point (§2.7).

2.4 Three tiers of reality

Advaita’s standard framework separates three levels of reality. Private apparent errors (*pratibhasika*) include a rope mistaken for a snake. Shared empirical reality (*vyavahara*) governs bodies, physical laws, ethics, and scripture. Absolute truth (*paramartha*) is Brahman alone. Discrimination (*viveka*) between the real and the unreal is defined as the firm conviction that Brahman alone is real and the uni-

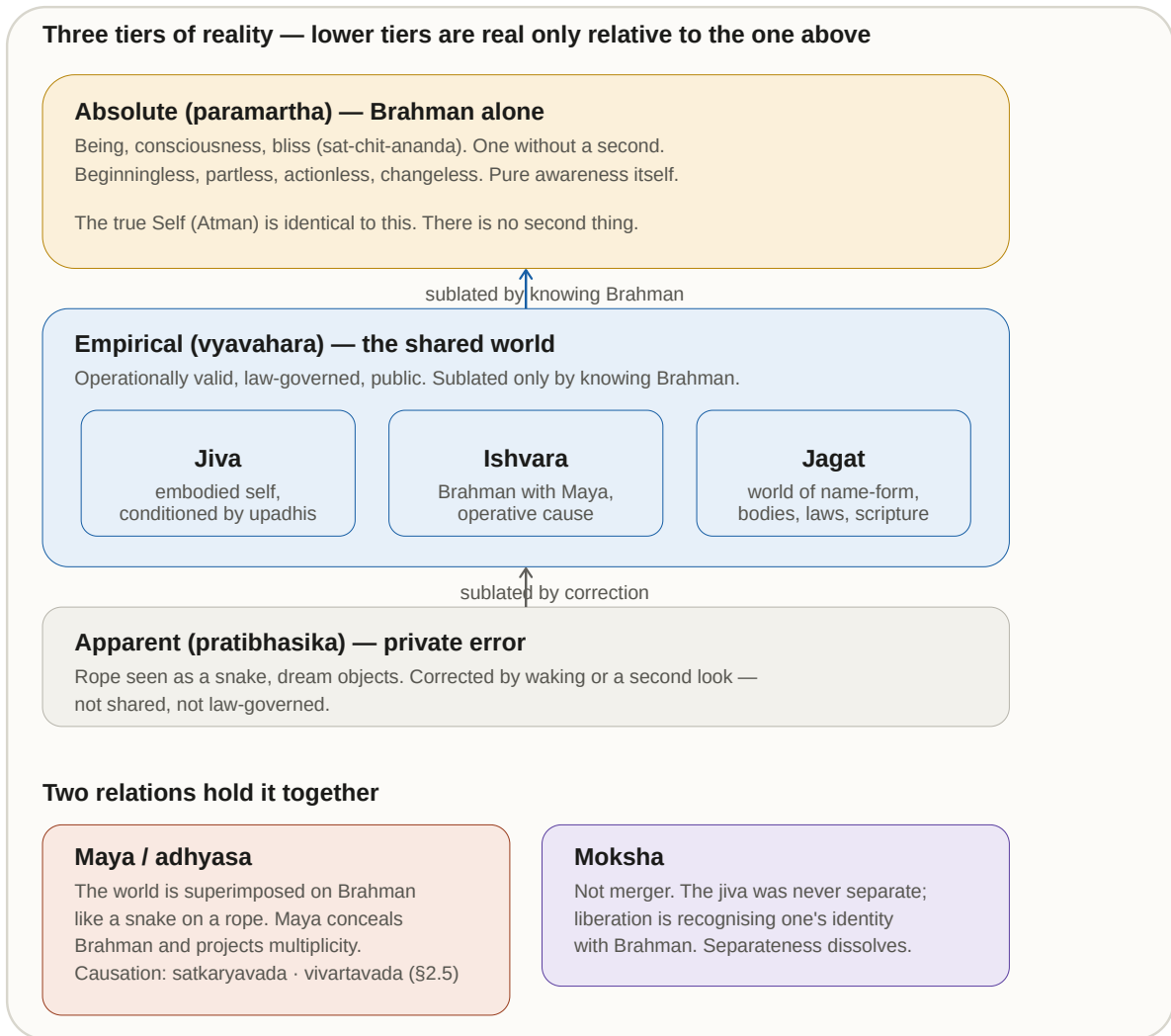
verse unreal (VC, v. 20); at the deepest level the individual soul is itself, directly, the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else (VC, v. 216).

The *mithya* doctrine and this three-tier framework are related but distinct tools, and the study keeps them apart. *Mithya* names the world’s dependent ontological status; the three tiers (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*) name the levels at which that status is assessed. Both are needed to read Advaita’s ontology.

Level	What exists?	Status of world / error
Apparent (<i>pratibhasika</i>)	Rope-snake, dream objects, private errors	Sublated by waking or correction
Empirical (<i>vyavahara</i>)	Bodies, minds, Ishvara, causes, duties, scriptures, science	Shared, law-governed; operationally valid; sublated only by <i>brahma-jnana</i>
Absolute (<i>paramartha</i>)	Brahman alone	World is <i>mithya</i> , dependent appearance

At *vyavahara*, the world is not unreal in the way a hallucination is; it is unreal relative to Brahman — like a dream relative to waking. The world is not sheer nothing, nor absolutely real; it is *mithya* — dependent appearance.

Later Advaita systematises this status as *anirvacaniya* — indescribable as either absolutely real or sheer nothing. Shankara himself uses “neither *sat* nor *asat*” language without that compound; *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* is a post-Shankara systematic term from the Vimuktatman and Vivarana school. That status is what later comparison must keep in view when ethics and science are assessed at *vyavahara* without treating the world as finally absolute (§2.10; §§5.3.2, 5.7, 6.3).



2.5 Maya, *adhyasa*, and causal doctrine

The multiplicity of the world rests on Brahman through superimposition (*adhyasa*) — like a snake seen on a rope. Cosmic Maya conceals Brahman's true nature (*avarana*) and projects the diversity of name-form (*vikshepa*). Avidya is the individual counterpart: not the cosmic power itself, but the jiva's own superimposition of body and mind on the Self. VC vv. 243–244 distinguish the two — Maya as Ishvara's superimposition, Avidya as the jiva's.

Advaita inherits *satkaryavada* from its Samkhya background: the effect pre-exists in the cause. The Chandogya's clay teaching states the pattern directly: through knowledge of one lump of clay, all things made of clay are known, since every transformation is a matter of speech and name while clay alone is real (CU 6.1.4). The *Vivekachudamani* compresses the same point: modifications of clay, such as the jar, are always accepted by the mind as real, yet in reality are nothing but clay; likewise this entire universe, produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman itself and nothing but that (VC, v. 251).

At the empirical level, creation is *vivartavada* — apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through Maya. The effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Creation is therefore not production from nothing; it is manifestation of

names and forms on the basis of Brahman. Comparative causal doctrine across traditions is tabulated in §5.4.

The stock error of mistaking a rope for a snake illustrates Advaita's theory of error (*khyativada*): the snake is neither real (it vanishes on knowledge) nor utterly unreal (it was genuinely experienced), but a projection on a real substrate — the same structure *Maya writ large* applies to the world until Brahman is known.

2.6 Ishvara, jiva, and jagat at vyavahara

Because Advaita uses a three-tier framework, it posits several categories structurally necessary to explain the empirical world, even if they are ultimately sublated at the absolute level.

Brahman at *paramartha* is *nirguna* — pure, actionless awareness. Ishvara (*saguna* Brahman) is Brahman associated with *Maya*, functioning as operative cause of name-form manifestation — not a creator *ex nihilo*. Ishvara is a *vyavahara*-level category, sublated at *paramartha*: Ishvara and jiva are themselves superimpositions — cosmic and individual respectively — and when these are perfectly eliminated, neither Ishvara nor jiva remains (VC, v. 244).

Jivatman (*jiva*) is the individual embodied soul — the true Self (*Atman*) conditioned by *upadhis* (limiting adjuncts), appearing as separate until realisation. Classical Advaita accounts for apparent plurality of jivas without making each an ultimate second: reflection (*pratibimba*) and limitation (*avaccheda*) name two standard ways the one Self appears many under adjuncts; this study need not decide between later school elaborations. The empirical person is further stacked as three bodies — gross (*sthula*), subtle (*sukshma*), and causal (*karana*) — and as five sheaths (*pancha kosha*: food, vital, mental, intellect, and bliss). Those layers are real equipment at *vyavahara*; they are not discarded as hallucination, yet they do not survive as separate individuality at *paramartha*. Shared Upanishadic sheath vocabulary with Madhyasth Darshan must not be read as a one-to-one ontological match (§5.7.2).

Karma and *samsara* belong to this same empirical mechanism: the conditioned jiva continues across births through residual action and impression until knowledge dispels the illusion of separateness. Continuity of the empirical person is therefore not proof that a distinct self is finally real.

Jagat (*nama-roopa*) is the physical universe of names and forms — operationally valid at *vyavahara*, ultimately *mithya* at *paramartha*. Bodies, minds, causal order, scripture, and science belong to this shared tier until *brahma-jnana* sublates the apparent separateness of the world from Brahman.

2.7 Witness-consciousness and the Self

The *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* (DDV) offers a rigorous seer-seen (*drig-drishya*) discrimination: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is “seen” and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5). What remains is *Sakshin*, witness-consciousness — irreducible to matter, and Advaita's primary first-person route for discriminating the Self from body and mind.

The Gita names this directly: the body is the field, and the one who knows it is the knower of the field; that same knower of the field in every field, it adds, is also the knowledge of the field itself (BG 13.1–

13.2). In the *Mandukya* analysis (§2.3), *turiya* plays the same structural role: not another state among states, but the awareness in which states appear (MU, vv. 3–7).

At liberation, that witness is discovered as non-personal Brahman — one partless awareness without a second. The dispute over whether irreducible awareness is finally one impersonal Self or many distinct knowers is reserved for §§5.3.3 and 5.6.

2.8 Conservation, origination, and temporality

Brahman does not begin: it is beginningless, partless, actionless, non-dual — outside temporal becoming (VC, v. 393). The universe as name-form has origination at the empirical level, but its ultimate truth is Brahman. Advaita's classical cosmology treats *vyavahara* as beginningless: *srishti*, *sthiti*, and *laya* — manifestation, maintenance, and dissolution — cycle without a first moment, so the empirical world is not a fleeting illusion in the manner of a private error (*pratibhasika*), nor a single absolute beginning of existence.

Advaita does not devote a separate chapter to *kaal*, but its framework implies a sharp division. At *paramartha*, only Brahman is absolutely real; temporality belongs to the empirical order. At *vyavahara*, past, present, and future, birth and death, and causal succession are operationally valid — the world is law-governed and shared (§2.4) — yet finally sublated when Brahman alone is known.

The *Mandukya* analysis of waking, dream, and deep sleep (§2.3) is a first-person route into how temporal states appear and are witnessed; the witness (*turiya*) is not another state among them. Fuller comparison of Advaita's *trikaal* language with Madhyasth Darshan's account of *kaal* as duration of unit-activity is developed in [Nature of Time](#).

2.9 Liberation and the knowledge path

Liberation (*moksha*) is not dissolution or merger of a real individual into Brahman. The *jiva* was never a separate entity; realisation is recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled. The classical identity formula is *tat tvam asi* — “That thou art” (CU 6.8.7, with Śaṅkara's *bhāṣya*); BS 1.1.2 treats the same doctrine systematically. The *Vivekachudamani* compresses the point: at the ultimate truth there is neither death nor birth, neither a bound nor a struggling soul, neither a seeker after liberation nor a liberated one (VC, v. 574) — for the Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless, and changeless, without interior or exterior: the one Existence, without a second, and one's own Self (VC, v. 393).

That recognition can obtain while the body still lives (*jivanmukti*) or is completed with the fall of the body (*videhamukti*). *Jivanmukti* is what makes *loka-sangraha* coherent after realisation: the knower continues to act in the world without reinstating separate individuality as final (§2.10).

Method serves that ontological claim rather than replacing it. Advaita inherits the classical analysis of valid knowledge (*pramana*): for the supreme truth of non-duality, verbal testimony (*shabda*) — the revealed word of the Upanishads, processed through reasoning and meditation — is finally competent; perception and inference operate within the subject-object duality to be transcended. The path is classically threefold: hearing (*shravana*), reasoning (*manana*), and sustained meditation (*nididhyasana*), under a qualified teacher. Teaching itself often proceeds by provisional attribution and later with-

drawal (*adhyaropa–apavada*): names and forms are first admitted for instruction, then negated until only the Self remains — the same logic as seer-seen discrimination in the DDV. Full epistemological comparison: [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#) §2.

Shankara’s *Vivekachudamani* insists on ethical discipline as prerequisite to knowledge (VC, vv. 17–19). Ethics at *vyavahara* is developed in §2.10.

2.10 Ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and what realisation evidences

Advaita’s charge that the world is *mithya* at *paramartha* does not make ethics untenable at the level where life is actually lived. At *vyavahara*, ethics and compassion remain fully valid; realisation of non-duality deepens rather than weakens them. The Bhagavad Gita, in Shankara’s commentary, grounds social responsibility in *loka-sangraha* — holding the world together — and ordained duty: perform your bounden duty, for action is superior to inaction (BG 3.8; Shankara’s commentary reads this as *niyatam kuru karma* — even the enlightened continue to act for the welfare of the world). *Jivanmukti* (§2.9) is the ontological condition of that continued action.

What Advaita provisions at the empirical order must be distinguished from what realisation evidences at *paramartha*. Ethics, scripture, causal law, and compassionate action prepare the mind for *brahma-jnana*; they are binding where humans actually live. None of this settles whether the world retains final ontological weight at the highest truth — that dispute is carried in §§5.3.2, 5.7, and 6.3.

Domain	Valid at <i>vyavahara</i>	Status at <i>paramartha</i>
Ethics and duty	Binding; deepens with realisation (VC, vv. 17–19; BG 3.8)	Sublated as means; non-dual identity remains
World and nature	Law-governed, shared, beginningless cosmology	<i>Mithya</i> — dependent appearance
Individual self	Real as embodied jiva under <i>upadhi</i>	Identical with Brahman; separateness dispelled
Relationships and society	<i>Loka-sangraha</i> , ordained action for world-welfare	Not ultimately separate from Brahman
Time and change	Past, present, future, birth and death operationally valid	Sublated when timeless Self is known

Realisation evidences identity with Brahman — the dispelled illusion of separate individuality. The enlightened still act for world-welfare at *vyavahara*; what changes at *paramartha* is ontological status, not the possibility of ethical living.

2.11 Method, evidence, and what Advaita establishes

Advaita Vedanta answers the study’s framing questions as follows:

Question	Advaita Vedanta answer	Section
What is existence?	Brahman alone — being, consciousness, bliss, one without a second	§§2.1–2.3
What exists?	Brahman absolutely; <i>jiva</i> , Ishvara, and <i>jagat</i> real only at <i>vyavahara</i>	§§2.4, 2.6
Does it begin?	Brahman does not begin; name-form cycles as <i>srishti–sthiti–laya</i> within beginningless <i>vyavahara</i>	§2.8
Does the self begin?	<i>Jivatman</i> is <i>vyavahara</i> -level conditioning; the true Self was never born and never separate	§§2.7, 2.9
Is the world real?	Operationally real at <i>vyavahara</i> ; <i>mithya</i> — dependent appearance — at <i>paramartha</i>	§§2.4–2.5
How do we know?	Scripture (<i>shabda</i>), reasoning, and contemplative discrimination — <i>shravana, manana, nididhyasana</i>	§2.9

Advaita establishes a rigorous non-dual ontology and a disciplined first-person method for discriminating seer from seen. Whether the world’s robustness at *vyavahara* settles its status at the highest truth is the comparative question carried forward in §6.3.

3. Modern Philosophical Approaches

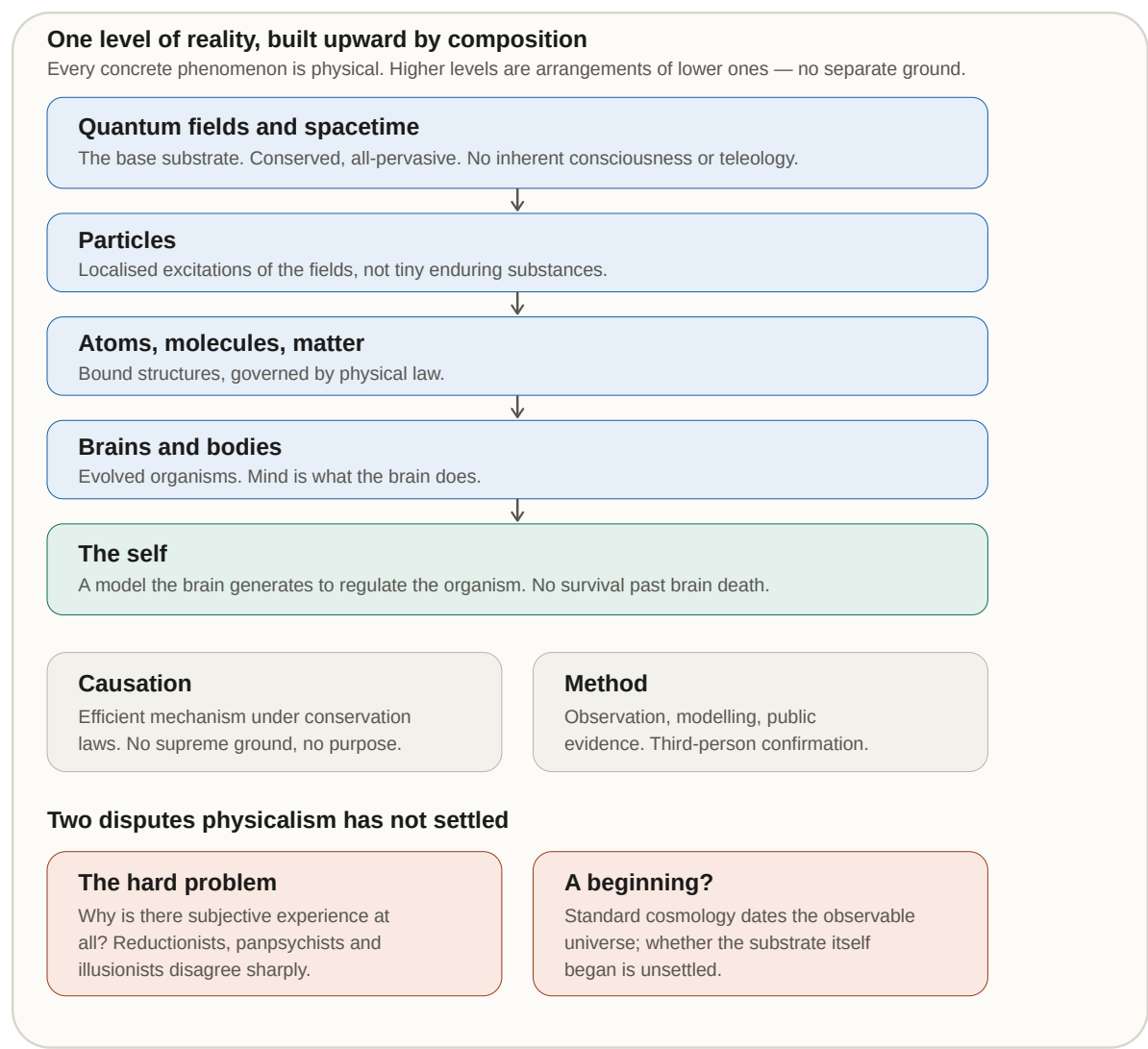
Modern Western philosophy takes physical nature as baseline and disputes how mind, self, value, and the world’s final status fit within it. The dominant materialist line holds that consciousness emerges from matter; metaphysical idealism has held the reverse. SB records that neither one-way emergence has been observed — what is evident is coexistence:

“In this course, metaphysical thought has held that matter arises from consciousness, whereas materialist thought has maintained that consciousness emerges from matter. Both ideologies have proposed numerous arguments, practices, and experiments in support of their claims. Yet, neither has matter been seen emerging from consciousness, nor consciousness emerging from matter. What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present.”

- SB, p. 48

Madhyasth Darshan’s own title — *Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad (Resolution Centred Materialism)* — reframes rather than abandons materialism. Against dialectical materialism, which treats struggle as the engine of history and science, SB proposes an orderliness-centred materialism in which nature remains real, saturated in Omnipresence, and oriented toward resolution rather than perpetual conflict (SB, pp. 8, 44). The Western debates below are the philosophical context that framing answers.

Section 3 states the modern philosophical baseline on its own terms: physicalist ontology and the hard problem, then self, world realism, and partial Western analogues to ground-and-units coexistence. Method and evidential stakes close the account. The figure below summarises the physicalist architecture; time and cosmology are developed in [Nature of Time](#) and §4. Comparative forks with Madhyasth Darshan belong in §§5–6.



3.1 Physicalist ontology: what exists

“I take physicalism to be the view that every real, concrete phenomenon in the universe is...physical.”
- Strawson 2006, p. 2

On this view, what exists are physical things, events, fields, organisms, brains, and processes. Minds and selves are not separate substances but functions, organisations, models, or processes of physical systems. Reductive physicalism holds that mental descriptions reduce without remainder to physical descriptions; non-reductive physicalism allows autonomous mental or functional levels while insisting that every concrete instance is still physical.

Methodological naturalism extends the picture into inquiry: the methods of the natural sciences — observation, experiment, modelling, public replication — are the standard for settling factual claims about the world. Scientific realism treats the physical world as mind-independent and law-governed: electrons, fields, and brains are not mere useful fictions but the furniture reality is made of, even when descriptions revise with theory change. Constructivist and instrumentalist variants soften that claim; they remain minority positions within mainstream analytic philosophy.

Physicalism also asserts causal closure: every physical event has a sufficient physical cause, so no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the nervous system (Kim 2005). That closure sets the bar for any claim that a non-physical partner works through the body: if the brain is a closed physical system, such a partner is either epiphenomenal or a violation of conservation. How that bar bears on immortal *jeevan* is examined in §§5.3.3 and 6.4.

3.2 The hard problem and the first-person datum

“The really hard problem of consciousness is the problem of experience. When we think and perceive, there is a whirl of information-processing, but there is also a subjective aspect.”

- Chalmers 1995, p. 3

“It is widely agreed that experience arises from a physical basis, but we have no good explanation of why and how it so arises.”

- Chalmers 1995, p. 3

“the fact that an organism has conscious experience at all means, basically, that there is something it is like to be that organism.”

- Nagel 1974, p. 1

The hard problem is not whether brains correlate with experience — they do — but why any physical process should have an inside at all. Physicalists often treat the gap as philosophically non-decisive — a limit of current theory, not proof of extra-physical being. First-person discrimination of seer from seen is developed on Advaita’s terms in §2.7; whether the gap gives positive support to Madhyasth Darshan’s distinct *jeevan* is examined in §§6.2.1 and 6.4.

Some philosophers split the difference through property dualism: experience may be an irreducible property of certain physical systems while the laws governing matter remain intact. That fork preserves law-governed physics but adds a primitive experiential aspect Chalmers-style accounts find unavoidable. Whether active sentience belongs to every complex physical system, or only to constitutionally complete units, is a comparative question for §§5.3.3 and 5.6.

3.3 Physicalist responses: panpsychism, emergentism, illusionism

Physicalists who take the hard problem seriously divide into several families. Panpsychist physicalism (Strawson 2006) insists that experience cannot emerge from wholly non-experiential matter:

“Full recognition of the reality of experience, then, is the obligatory starting point for any remotely realistic version of physicalism.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 2

“Experiential phenomena cannot be emergent from wholly non-experiential phenomena.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 12

“Real physicalism, realistic physicalism, entails panpsychism.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 12

Panpsychism refuses experience-from-dead-matter while remaining inside a physicalist frame. Madhyasth Darshan does not distribute experience among material particles or identify Omnipotence with a universal subject. It locates sentience only in the constitutionally complete atom called *jeevan* (§1.6.1). Strawson’s argument therefore presses physicalist emergence but does not supply Madhyasth Darshan’s account: the darshan presents constitutional completeness as its own qualitative transition within the development of the atom.

Panpsychism’s combination problem follows. If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into a unified macro-subject? Strawson and other panpsychists leave this wound open; integrated information theory addresses it through structural integration, often at the cost of pan-experiential commitments (§4.2). Madhyasth Darshan does not inherit this precise problem because *jeevan* is one constitutionally complete unit, not an assembly of micro-subjects. Its exposed question is instead how that claimed constitutional state can be independently identified (§6.2.1).

Emergentism offers a middle path: new properties appear at organisational thresholds — digestion from chemistry, life from biochemistry, mind from neural complexity. Weak emergence treats higher-level patterns as real but dependent on lower-level physics; strong emergence would add causally novel properties irreducible to microphysics. Constitutional completeness also marks a qualitative threshold, but the resemblance is formal rather than explanatory. Madhyasth Darshan places the transition in a particular atom whose constitution becomes closed and free from molecular and weight bondage; biological emergentism places sentience in organised living systems. The critical question is whether these different proposed thresholds can be operationally distinguished (§6.2.1).

At the opposite pole, illusionism (Frankish 2016) and eliminative materialism (Dennett 1991; Churchland 1986) preserve physicalism by denying or re-describing the datum the hard problem presses:

“Another approach, which holds that phenomenal consciousness is an illusion and aims to explain why it seems to exist.”

- Frankish 2016, p. 1

“illusionists deny the existence of phenomenal consciousness properly so-called, but do not deny the existence of a form of consciousness”

- Frankish 2016, p. 8

Illusionists retain access-consciousness, self-report, and functional control while treating “what it is like” as a misdescription of introspective models. Eliminativists go further: folk-psychological categories such as belief and desire may fail to refer, to be replaced by neuroscience. These views show how far naturalism will go to preserve a physicalist ontology — and why predictive-processing accounts (§4.1) offer a more sophisticated functionalist reply than bare elimination. Whether experience, valuation, and realisation are activities of a distinct sentient unit is reserved for §§5.3.3 and 6.4.

3.4 The self: personal identity and persistence

Physicalism’s answer to “does the individual self begin or end with the body?” is typically yes, in some version. The self is a biological and cognitive achievement — developing through embodiment, memory, and social recognition — and ceasing when brain function ends. Personal identity theory asks what, if anything, makes a person the same individual over time.

Locke’s classical account ties identity to psychological continuity — memory and connectedness of consciousness — rather than to sameness of material particles. Parfit’s later work argues that what matters in survival is psychological connectedness and continuity, not a further fact of identity: there is no deep entity beyond the stream of mental states that must persist (Parfit 1984; SEP Personal Identity). On reductionist readings, post-death survival of a distinct individual has no fact of the matter beyond causal and psychological links — which bodily death breaks.

Substance views — rational soul as form of the body (§3.6.1), simple monads (§3.6.3) — preserve an enduring individual bearer. Against physicalism, the dispute is not only metaphysical but causal: if the physical domain is closed, a non-physical enduring self is either epiphenomenal or a violation of closure. Self-model, predictive-processing, and integrated-information accounts in cognitive science (§§4.1–4.2) explain the sense of self without positing an immortal unit. Whether regulation and representation settle what works through the brain is examined in §§6.2.1 and 6.4.

3.5 Origination, conservation, and world realism

Western philosophy asks whether what exists had a beginning and whether particulars endure through change. Mainstream physicalism holds that local systems — organisms, stars, civilisations — begin and end, while fundamental physics may or may not require a cosmic beginning (§4.3). Conservation principles in physics treat certain quantities as preserved through transformation — a structural parallel later compared with *vastu* through *roop*-change (§1.14, §4.4), though the categories differ.

Scientific realism answers “is the world finally real?” with yes for the physical universe: tables, fields, and brains are real mind-independent items suitable for public study. Idealism (Berkeley and successors) makes reality depend on perception or mind; nihilism denies that anything ultimately exists or matters. Both are outliers in contemporary analytic ontology but sharpen the stakes for any claim that the world is perpetual and co-eternally real with its ground (§1.14; §5.3.2).

Philosophy of time adds a further fork. Block-universe eternalism treats past, present, and future as equally real coordinates; presentism privileges the present. Relational theories deny time as an independent container — time is the order of change among things. Activity-based accounts of duration are structurally closer to relational and process views than to block eternalism ([Nature of Time](#) §3).

Cosmological questions about a beginningless substrate are developed in §4.3; the philosophical point here is that Western ontology has no consensus on whether existence as a whole begins, even when particular configurations do.

On ethics and life's purpose, typical physicalist answers are naturalized rather than grounded in immortal units or a non-dual absolute. Evolutionary ethics, social-contract and consequentialist theories, and accounts of flourishing treat value as arising from biology, psychology, and social practice; purpose, where acknowledged, is adaptation, well-being, or human-constructed meaning. That telos is operationalized further in evolutionary and ecological science (§4.6) and compared in §5.3.6.

3.6 Alternative Western ontologies

Physicalism (§§3.1–3.5) is the dominant modern baseline. Before the twentieth-century focus on mind and brain, Western metaphysics also developed several ground-plus-particulars schemes that map partially onto coexistence. They are ordered here from form-matter compounds through monism and pluralism to neutral ground — not as a historical timeline, and not as rivals that replace the physicalist baseline, but as a ladder of analogues for §5.5.

3.6.1 Hylomorphism and soul-as-form

Aristotelian–Thomistic hylomorphism maps form (*forma*) onto matter (*materia*) so that a substance is the compound of both — not mere aggregation. Aquinas treats the rational soul as the form of the living body (*anima forma corporis*), giving a joint ontology of soul-and-body that parallels Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan–shareer* joint form and the four-aspect unit signature (form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*) as what a unit is (§1.3). *Gathanpurnata* resembles substantial completion: a definite constitution at which a unit's essential nature is fully actualised. The divergences are sharp: Madhyasth Darshan's plural, immortal *jeevan* units, beginningless coexistence with *satta*, and saturation are not Aristotelian prime matter plus a single rational soul per body; yet the soul-as-form debate is a nearer cousin than process philosophy on individual persistence (SEP Form and Matter; Aquinas ST I, q. 75–76).

3.6.2 Spinoza: substance and modes

Spinoza's substance monism offers a closer analogue to *satta*-with-units than neutral monism. For Spinoza, one infinite substance (*Deus sive Natura*) has infinitely many modes — finite particulars expressing the one substance under different attributes (thought and extension). Madhyasth Darshan likewise keeps a pervasive ground and countless real units, but the contrast is decisive: Spinoza has one substance whose modes are not ontologically on a par with the whole; Madhyasth Darshan has co-eternal *satta* and *ikai*, each real in its own right, bound by saturation rather than modal expression of a single substance (Spinoza, *Ethics*, Part I, Props. 14–15; Part II, Def. 3). Spinoza's parallelism of thought and extension also differs from Madhyasth Darshan's tiered intelligibility: active *chaitanya* belongs only to *jeevan*, not to every mode of extension.

3.6.3 Leibniz: monads and harmony

Leibnizian monads offer a tighter analogue to plural immortal *jeevan* than Whitehead's occasions. Monads are simple, individual substances that mirror the whole from their perspective, do not interact by efficient causation but harmonize, and do not naturally perish. That plurality-with-harmony and individual immortality align structurally with many distinct *jeevan*-clouds saturated in Omnipresence (MVD, p. 13). The contrast: monads are windowless and perception-based; *jeevan* works through bodies in definite *sambandh* and fulfils relationships in nature's orders (Leibniz, *Monadology*, §§1–14, 78–81).

3.6.4 Process philosophy: occasions and becoming

Whitehead's process philosophy shares relational realism and refusal of nature bifurcation. His basic units are "actual entities" — "drops of experience, complex and interdependent" (Whitehead 1929, p. 28). The ultimate for Whitehead is creativity, the principle by which the many prior occasions become one new occasion; each occasion's concrescence — its growing-together from that inherited data — aims at intensity of experience before it perishes (Whitehead 1929). The key contrast remains persistence: Whitehead's occasions are momentary and "perpetually perish" subjectively, gaining "objective immortality" only as data for successors (Whitehead 1929, p. 44), whereas Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan* is a persisting immortal individual. Process metaphysics also treats time as internal to becoming — a partial affinity with activity-based *kaal* (§3.5; [Nature of Time](#) §3.3).

"Actual entities 'perpetually perish' subjectively, but are immortal objectively."

- Whitehead 1929, p. 44

3.6.5 Neutral monism: common ground

Neutral monism (Russell, Mach) resembles Omnipresence as a reality that is neither mind nor matter but common ground. Russell holds that mind and matter are "composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material" (Russell 1921, Lecture I). Mach likewise denies any "rift between the psychical and the physical": "There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed" (Mach 1914, Ch. XIV). The contrast: neutral monism typically builds mind and matter out of the neutral stuff, whereas Madhyasth Darshan keeps Omnipresence non-transforming and lets units be real in their own right rather than constructed from the ground.

"Both mind and matter are composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material."

- Russell 1921, Lecture I

"There is no rift between the psychical and the physical, no inside and outside... There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed."

- Mach 1914, Ch. XIV

The Western schemes above — hylomorphism, substance monism, monads, process occasions, neutral ground — chiefly dispute how ground relates to particulars and whether individual selves endure. Process philosophy treats occasions as perpetually perishing; physicalism (§§3.1–3.4) reads the self as embodied achievement rather than immortal substance. Those lines attack the permanence of the self while largely retaining the grammar of countable entities in relation — the same grammar §5.5 tabulates.

3.7 Method, evidence, and what philosophy establishes

Modern Western philosophy does not speak with one voice, but a typical physicalist constellation answers the study’s framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical Western philosophical answer
What is existence?	Concrete physical reality — fields, spacetime, organisms — studied empirically; some add experience as fundamental (panpsychism) or neutral ground (neutral monism).
What exists?	Physical entities and their organisations; minds as processes; disputed whether experience is reducible, fundamental, or illusory.
Does what exists begin?	Particular systems begin and end; whether fundamentals had a first moment is unsettled (§3.5, §4.3).
Does the individual self begin?	The self develops with body and brain; psychological continuity does not survive bodily death on standard physicalist accounts (§3.4).
Is the world finally real?	Yes, for scientific realism — the physical world is mind-independent; idealism and world-as-illusion are minority views.
Method of knowing	Observation, argument, public evidence; first-person datum acknowledged but not treated as existence-proof for immortal units.

What philosophy has established is a high evidential bar and a persistent exposed point: the hard problem shows that reductive matter-only accounts leave experience unexplained. What it has not established is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or post-death continuity — an explanatory gap is not an existence proof (§6.4). Predictive processing and self-model theories (§4.1) deepen the physicalist reply without settling the ontological dispute (§6.4).

Mainstream science inherits this physicalist baseline and adds measurement, formal models, and institutional replication — the subject of §4.

4. Modern Scientific Approaches

Mainstream science inherits the physicalist baseline of §3 and adds measurement, formal models, and institutional replication. Where philosophy disputes mind, self, and world-realness in argument, sci-

ence operationalises those disputes through instruments, datasets, and peer review. SB records that humans seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience — not through argument alone:

“Humans inherently seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience. They desire to achieve comprehensive resolution — across various aspects, perspectives, directions, dimensions, and contexts of time and place.”

- SB, p. 44

Madhyasth Darshan treats public science as one leg of that evidence-seeking — strong on mechanism, prediction, and correction. It adds realisation and conduct as further evidence of understanding — the epistemic frame developed in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#). JV notes that the human body is provisioned to evidence understanding, not merely to house brain activity (JV, p. 59).

Section 4 states how science operationalises the physicalist baseline: mind and self in neuroscience, consciousness-science rivals, cosmology, fields and conservation, spacetime and entropy, then evolution and ecology. Method and what science establishes close the section. Time physics is in [Nature of Time](#); limits of science are critiqued in §6.4.

4.1 Mind, self, and predictive processing

Self-model theories in cognitive science (Metzinger 2003) operationalize the physicalist account of personal identity in §3.4: the self is not an immortal unit but a predictive model the brain generates to regulate the organism.

“minimal selfhood emerges as the result”

- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 1

“these accounts propose to ‘understand the elusive sense of minimal self in terms of having internal models that successfully predict or match the sensory consequences of our own movement, our intentions in action, and our sensory input’.”

- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 3

The most developed recent form is predictive processing and active inference: the brain as a hierarchically deep generative model that minimizes prediction error (surprise) by updating beliefs and guiding action (Friston 2010; Clark 2016). On this view, valuation, aspiration, the sense of being a continuous self, and the felt reality of the world are not dismissed as mere illusion; they are functionally real control structures — layered expectations that keep the organism viable. Seth (2021) extends the picture: conscious selfhood is the brain’s “best guess” about its own embodiment, a controlled hallucination tuned by interoceptive and sensorimotor evidence.

Science’s operational criterion for when that regulative process ends is brain death — irreversible loss of whole-brain function. On that standard, the person ceases when neural integration fails; there is no post-death survival of the self for medicine to measure. Predictive models explain how a body self-

regulates; whether the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct sentient unit working through the brain is examined in §§5.3.3, 6.2.1, and 6.4.

4.2 Consciousness science: IIT, autopoiesis, and rival programs

Integrated Information Theory (IIT) proposes that consciousness corresponds to integrated information (Φ) in a system, with a quantitative threshold producing a qualitative difference — “an experience is a maximally irreducible conceptual structure” (Tononi 2012). IIT is a useful physicalist mirror of threshold grammar: like constitutional completeness, it ties consciousness to a structural condition. The contrasts for later comparison are decisive: IIT is pan-experiential at the fundamental level in many formulations, operational and measurement-oriented, and silent on immortal individual units or coexistential ground (§§1.2, 6.2.1).

Autopoiesis (Maturana and Varela) treats living organisation as a self-producing network that maintains its boundary and identity through continuous metabolism — “a machine organised as a network of processes of production of components” that “continuously regenerate and realize the network that produces them” (Maturana and Varela 1980, p. 78). That organisational closure offers a limited analogy to self-maintaining biological order. It is not Madhyasth Darshan’s constitutional completeness: autopoiesis describes a metabolic network, whereas *gathanpurnata* describes a constitutionally closed atom that the darshan identifies as sentient *jeevan*.

Contemporary consciousness science has no settled account. Competing programs — integrated information, global neuronal workspace, higher-order theory, recurrent processing, and others — offer different structural criteria for when experience is present. Adversarial tests have partly supported and partly challenged leading theories without producing consensus. For this study, the comparison is limited: science proposes publicly testable system-level criteria, while the primary Madhyasth Darshan texts identify a constitutionally complete sentient atom but do not provide a corresponding physical measurement procedure (§6.2.1).

4.3 Cosmology and cosmic beginnings

The Λ CDM standard model treats the observable universe as expanding from a hot dense state roughly 13.8 billion years ago — a cosmic beginning for the universe we can observe. That model is extraordinarily successful on large-scale structure, nucleosynthesis, and the cosmic microwave background. It does not by itself answer whether existence as a whole began, or only this cosmic epoch.

Several non-singular research programs explore a beginningless physical substrate from which local universes or phases arise. Loop quantum cosmology replaces the initial singularity with a “bounce” from a prior contracting phase (Ashtekar and Singh 2011). Penrose’s conformal cyclic cosmology posits successive aeons, each with its own big bang (Penrose 2010). Eternal inflation treats our observable patch as one bubble in a potentially infinite multiverse (Guth 2007). These are competing speculative programs, not consensus — the most this comparison claims is conceptual resonance with Madhyasth Darshan’s claim that nature (*prakriti*) is perpetual (*satat*), not proof that *jagat satat* is established by cosmology (§1.14, §6.2.3).

4.4 Quantum fields, particles, and conservation

Particle–antiparticle annihilation and pair creation are not passages into or out of absolute non-being. In quantum field theory, particles are localized excitations of conserved, all-pervasive fields, and annihilation transforms one excitation (matter) into another (radiation) under strict conservation laws (Weinberg 1995). This is broadly consonant with Madhyasth Darshan’s claim that fundamental reality (*vastu*) is conserved while configurations (*roop*) transform (§1.14) — though the alignment must be handled with care.

What persists in QFT are field configurations and conserved quantities; a “particle” is a localized excitation, not a tiny enduring substance. Madhyasth Darshan’s *vastu* names an underlying reality that survives every *roop*-change in countable units with *dharma* saturated in Omnipresence. The parallel is structural, not identity of category: fields are mathematical-physical entities governed by equations, not bounded *ikai* in coexistence.

Comparing *satta* to a physical field is misleading for the same reason. A dynamical field carries energy-momentum, exerts force, and propagates waves — nothing like the actionless (*kriya-shunya*), non-transforming *satta* (§1.2). The nearest physical analogue — non-dynamical background geometry or the quantum vacuum ground state — captures only that units depend on a uniform ground; it drops the darshan’s second half: uniform energy stays unmanifest without unit activity (§1.2). Energy conservation itself is subtle in General Relativity: it is tied, via Noether’s theorem, to time-symmetry that need not hold globally in an expanding spacetime (Carroll 2010).

4.5 Spacetime, entropy, and order

Modern physics treats spacetime as a dynamical entity — it can expand, curve, and in some models exhibit local beginnings. Madhyasth Darshan treats *kaal* as the duration of unit-activity, numerically reckoned by humans within existence (§1.6.4; SB, pp. 65, 251; MVD, pp. 34, 195) — not an independent cosmic container. Omnipresence is timeless as non-transforming ground. The contrast is over whether temporality belongs to the ground of reality or only to transforming units, and over whether spacetime is fundamental physics or derivative of measurement conventions on activity. Relational and process philosophies of time (§3.6.4; §3.5) share some structural affinity with activity-based *kaal*; block-universe eternalism does not. Comparative detail: [Nature-Of-Time](#).

Thermodynamic entropy describes a statistical arrow toward disorder in closed systems. Madhyasth Darshan asserts inherent orderliness (*vyavastha*) at every order, with development toward greater organisation when units are in their natural state. These are not straightforward opposites — biological and ecological systems can increase local order at the cost of entropy elsewhere — but they use different notions of “order.” The second law neither supports nor refutes coexistence orderliness.

4.6 Evolution, ecology, and cooperation

Natural selection is mainstream biology’s mechanism for adaptation: heritable variation plus differential reproduction produces organisms fitted to their environments. On this picture, bodies, brains, and behavioural strategies — including cooperation — are products of evolutionary history, not eternal units with ontologically fixed *dharma*.

Madhyasth Darshan’s *niyati-kram* asserts a definite order of manifestation — material to pranic to animal to knowledge on Earth (§1.5) — whereas evolutionary biology explains adaptation through contingent variation and selection. These accounts operate at different descriptive levels, but their relation is not yet worked out: MD names ordered existential transitions, while science reconstructs branching taxonomies and lineages (§6.2.3).

Ecology treats organisms as nodes in interdependent networks: energy flows, nutrient cycles, symbiosis, and competition. Cooperation among conspecifics and across species is widely studied as an evolved strategy — kin selection, reciprocity, mutualism — not as ontologically real *mulya* (value) fulfilled in definite *sambandh* (§1.4). Madhyasth Darshan does not deny biological interdependence; it denies that ecological cooperation replaces inherent value-recognition and fulfilment at the knowledge order. At the human–nature relation, MD names utility (*upyogita*) and art (*kala*) — making natural abundance usable and enhancing that usefulness through aesthetic labour (MVD pp. 56–57, 324; JV p. 77) — not a generic claim that value is “structurally real” without category. Science explains how cooperative behaviour arises; MD claims complementarity, essentiality-as-value, and utility–art on nature are already structurally real in coexistence (§1.4).

Against all of these, Madhyasth Darshan makes stronger metaphysical claims: coexistence is eternal, units are not annihilated, and *jeevan* is immortal. That eternalism is consistent with conservation principles and beginningless cosmological models; individual immortality and constitutional completeness are distinct commitments examined in §6.2.

4.7 Method, evidence, and what science establishes

Modern science does not speak with one voice across every specialty, but a typical physical-science constellation answers the study’s framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical scientific answer
What is existence?	Dynamical spacetime, quantum fields, and their excitations — studied through observation, experiment, and mathematical models.
What exists?	Matter, energy, fields, organisms, brains; minds as functional/processual features of neural systems.
Does what exists begin?	The observable universe ~13.8 Ga on Λ CDM; whether any substrate is beginningless is unsettled (§4.3).
Does the individual self begin?	Self develops with brain and body; brain death ends the person operationally; no measured post-death continuity (§4.1).
Is the world finally real?	Yes — the physical world is mind-independent and law-governed, publicly testable.
Method of knowing	Observation, instrumentation, modelling, replication, peer review; third-person confirmation.

What science has established is precise mechanism, prediction, and correction across domains from particle physics to neuroscience. What it has not established — on Madhyasth Darshan’s reading — is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness at *gathanpurnata*, or post-death continuity of a sentient unit. An explanatory gap in the hard problem (§3.2) is not an existence proof for *jeevan*; predictive accuracy alone does not settle whether the regulator is only neural or a distinct unit working through the brain (§6.4, §5.3.5). The comparative synthesis begins in §5.

5. Comparison

Sections §§1–4 stated Madhyasth Darshan, Advaita Vedanta, and modern philosophical and scientific approaches on their own terms. This section synthesizes them across three fault lines: whether existence is exhausted by matter and mechanism; whether the world retains final ontological weight; and whether an immortal individual self is established. Time is treated separately in [Nature of Time](#).

§5.1 names the pairwise alliances first. The summary table and prose contrasts then deepen those forks; causal doctrine, entity structure, and the Advaita structural comparison follow.

5.1 Where the alliances fall

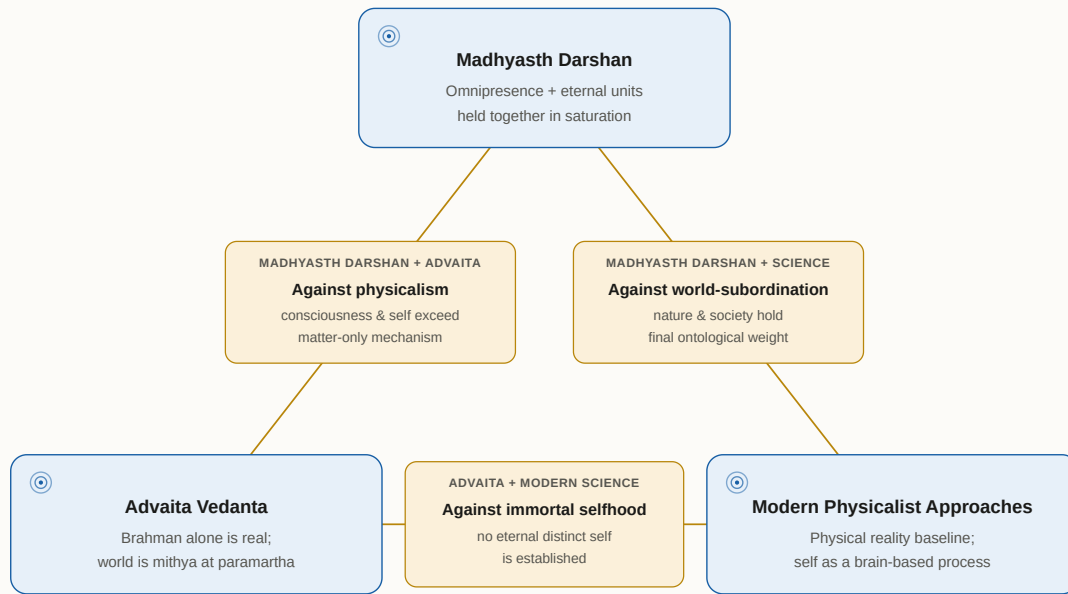
No single tradition wins every dispute. Three pairwise patterns clarify what each view shares with and denies to the others:

Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita against physicalism. Both refuse to treat existence as merely physicochemical matter. Consciousness, value, and the self are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena. Against reductive materialism, both hold that something more than bare mechanism is required — though they disagree sharply on what that “more” is. Advaita’s *Sakshin* / *turiya* route and Madhyasth Darshan’s constitutionally complete *jeevan* both reject the predictive self-model picture in which the self is only a hierarchical brain construct (§4.1). Madhyasth Darshan identifies the knower as a distinct sentient atom working through the body; it does not make *satta* a universal mind (§§1.1, 1.7).

Madhyasth Darshan and science against Advaita. Both treat the world as real and worth studying. Matter, bodies, relationships, and ecological order are not finally *mithya* or preparatory illusion. Against *paramartha* sublation of the world — final world-subordination, not a denial of ethics at *vyavahara* — both insist that nature and society have final weight, though science does not affirm Omnipresence or immortal *jeevan*. Quantum field conservation and public cosmology treat physical nature as law-governed and investigable (§4.4); Madhyasth Darshan’s *jagat satat* agrees that the world is perpetual and real at the highest truth, against Advaita’s *paramartha* sublation of name-form (§2.5).

Advaita and science against Madhyasth Darshan. Both set a high bar for claims that exceed public evidence. Advaita holds that separate individuality was never ultimately real (VC, v. 574); science treats the self as a biological process that ceases at brain death (§4.1). Against Madhyasth Darshan’s eternal distinct sentient units, both deny — on different grounds — that an immortal individual self is established.

Where the Alliances Fall



Each pair agrees on something the third denies — see §5.1

Each pair agrees on something the third denies. Comparative clarity depends on naming which question is at stake: matter-only reduction, world-reality, or individual immortality.

5.2 Cross-tradition summary

The table below aggregates modern physicalist approaches — the philosophical baseline of §3 and the scientific operationalizations of §4 — in one column for the study’s framing questions. Philosophy and science are split into separate columns only in §5.5, where their entity types diverge (hylomorphism versus quantum fields, witness versus predictive self-model). Section pointers sit beside each question; §5.3 develops the contrasts in prose.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
What is existence? (§§5.3.1, 5.5.1, 5.6)	Eternally present coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units held in it.	Brahman / Existence alone, one without a second.	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically.
What exists? (§§5.3.1–5.3.2, 5.5.1)	Omnipresence and real units, sentient and insentient.	Brahman alone (absolutely); world <i>mithya</i> at <i>paramartha</i> .	Usually the physical; experience disputed.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
Does it begin? (§§5.3.4, 5.4)	No — what exists does not come from non-existence; bodies and configurations do.	Brahman does not begin; name-form at <i>vyavahara</i> .	Particular systems begin and end; cosmology unsettled.
Does the individual self begin? (§§5.3.3, 5.5.1, 5.6)	<i>Jeevan</i> does not begin at birth or die with the body.	<i>Jiva</i> is ultimately Brahman; separate individuality dispelled at realisation (VC, vv. 244, 574).	Self develops as biological/cognitive process.
What is time? (Nature of Time)	Duration of unit-activity; human numerical reckoning within existence; <i>satta</i> timeless as ground (§1.6.4).	Brahman beyond temporal becoming; time valid at <i>vyavahara</i> , sublated at <i>paramartha</i> .	Spacetime as dynamical physical structure; philosophy of time contested.
Is the world finally real? (§§5.3.2, 5.7)	Yes. “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.”	Empirically valid but ultimately <i>mithya</i> .	Yes, as physical reality.
Method of knowing (§5.3.5)	Study → experiment and practice → realisation with evidence in conduct.	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination.	Observation, modelling, public evidence.
Ethical consequence (§§5.3.6, 5.5.2)	Humane conduct evidences understanding of coexistence.	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation.	Ethics via naturalism, social/normative theory.

5.3 Key contrasts

5.3.1 Ground and existence

Existence itself is answered differently at the root. Madhyasth Darshan holds eternally present coexistence (*saha-astitva*): formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless real units (*ikai*) held in saturation, neither made from the other (§1.2). Advaita Vedanta holds Brahman alone — being, consciousness, bliss, one without a second — as absolutely real; the manifold world is dependent appearance at the highest truth (§2.4). Modern physicalist approaches take concrete physical reality as baseline: fields, organisms, brains, and processes, studied empirically without positing an actionless omnipresent ground (§3.1). Western ground-plus-particulars schemes — hylomorphism, Spinoza’s substance and modes, Leibniz’s monads, process creativity, neutral monism (§3.6) — supply partial analogues to coexistence; none names saturation or constitutional *jeevan*. The Advaita–Madhyasth fork on ground is deepened in §§5.6–5.7; the entity snapshot is in §5.5.1.

5.3.2 World realism

Whether the world retains final ontological weight divides Madhyasth Darshan from Advaita, while partially aligning it with scientific realism. Madhyasth Darshan holds *jagat satat* — the world is perpetual and real at every level of realisation: “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual” (MVD, p. 13; §1.14). Advaita’s three-tier scheme (*paramartha*, *vyavahara*, *pratibhasika*) makes the empirical world robust for ethics and daily life yet *mithya* — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing — at *paramartha* (§§2.4–2.5). Modern scientific realism treats the physical world as mind-independent and law-governed (§3.1); that is not the same as Omnipresence, but it allies with Madhyasth Darshan against final world-subordination. Advaita’s reply — beginningless *vyavahara*, *loka-sangraha*, preparatory ethics (§2.10) — does not settle whether the world survives sublation; §5.7 treats *mithya* as the unmappable category.

5.3.3 Self, consciousness, and survival

On selfhood, Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita stand together against reductive physicalism, and apart from each other on individuality. Madhyasth Darshan holds many immortal, constitutionally complete *jeevan* units — real sentient atoms that work through bodies (§§1.6–1.7). Advaita holds the true Self is Brahman; separate *jivatman* is *vyavahara* superimposition dispelled at liberation (VC, vv. 244, 574; §2.6). Modern approaches treat the self as a brain-generated process: predictive self-models, integrated-information thresholds, or evolved cognitive agents, with brain death as the operational end of the person (§4.1). Physicalist rivals — strong emergence, panpsychism, illusionism (§§3.2–3.3) — dispute how experience arises but not, in the mainstream, post-death survival of a distinct unit. How consciousness is assigned to ground and knower — expanding the Cosmic Ground and Individual Self rows of §5.5.1 — is tabulated in §5.6.

5.3.4 Causation and beginninglessness

On beginninglessness, the three traditions diverge over whether anything arises from non-existence and whether the cause itself transforms. The full doctrinal comparison — *satkaryavada* / *vivartavada*, *mahakaran* with *shram-gati-parinam*, and efficient causation under conservation — is owned in §5.4; §5.5.2 cross-references that table rather than repeating it.

5.3.5 Method and what counts as evidence

The three systems do not merely give different answers; they use different criteria for knowing. Madhyasth Darshan treats knowing as a staged path: (1) study — logical comparison through observation, examination, and survey (MVD pp. 88, 115); (2) experiment and practice — behaviour and work as trial (MVD p. 88; SB p. 44); (3) realisation with evidence — *anubhav* closing the MVD p. 12 chain so understanding becomes evident in humane living and tradition. Deep fixity in conduct follows realisation-based study rather than argument alone (MVD p. 88; Ch. 17). Advaita reserves ultimate competence for scripture processed through reasoning and contemplative discrimination — DDV, *shravana-manana-nididhyasana* (§2.9). Modern science trusts observation, modelling, replication, and public measurement (§4).

Tradition	Method	Adequate for
Madhyasth Darshan	Study → experiment and practice → realisation with evidence in conduct	Coexistence as lived evidence; conduct as proof of understanding
Advaita	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination (DDV, VC)	Self as Brahman; sublation of <i>mithya</i>
Physicalism	Observation, modelling, public evidence	Mechanism, prediction, third-person confirmation

To that extent the traditions are partially incommensurable — no single neutral tribunal settles them. Comparative work can still test internal consistency, fit with public knowledge, and responsible distinction of posits from bare assertion. Full epistemology and the standards of realisation as proof: [*Knowledge, Knower, and Known*](#) §§1.6–1.8.

5.3.6 Ethics and life’s purpose

Telos follows ontology. Madhyasth Darshan seeks awakened coexistence (*jagriti*): realisation of coexistence expressed as resolved humane conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) in society, with ontologically real values (*mulya*) and relationships (*sambandh*) (§§1.4, 1.15). Advaita seeks liberation (*moksha*): recognition of identity with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate self is dispelled; ethics at *vyavahara* purifies the mind for that end (§2.10). Modern physicalist approaches explain ethics through evolution, psychology, social contract, or naturalized normativity; life’s purpose, where acknowledged, is adaptation, flourishing, or human-constructed meaning (§§3.5, 4.6). Madhyasth Darshan ties fulfilment to conduct-evidence, Advaita to sublation, and science to mechanism and survival — three different standards for whether a life is well-lived, revisited in the Relationships and Purpose rows of §5.5.2.

5.4 Causal doctrine: *Satkaryavada*, *Vivartavada*, and Madhyasth Darshan

Causal doctrine is the deepest structural difference on the beginninglessness axis (§5.2, “Does it begin?”; §5.3.4).

Advaita (Sankhya inheritance): *Satkaryavada* — the effect pre-exists in the cause (clay-pot, VC v. 251). At the empirical level, creation is *vivartavada*: apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman — the effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through *Maya*.

Madhyasth Darshan: Denies single-material-cause reduction and linear efficient-cause chains. *Satta* is *mahakaran* (supreme sustaining cause), not efficient cause (§1.6.4). Units change through the single activity triad *shram–gati–parinam*, read toward completeness in sentient nature through projection, reflection, and *samadhan*, with circular activity, order-specific cyclicity, and *sanskar*-mediated human cycles. Conservation of *vastu* through *roop*-change resembles *parinamavada* at the unit level, but the full picture is not reducible to “*parinamavada*-like” alone.

Modern physicalism: Strict efficient causation — mechanism, fields, conservation laws. Origination of particular systems is compatible with a beginningless substrate (§4.3); no teleology or supreme ground.

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Effect in cause?	Yes (<i>satkaryavada</i>)	Units eternal; change is transformation within coexistence	Conservation laws; particles as field excitations
Cause transforms?	No (Brahman changeless; <i>vivarta</i>)	<i>Satta</i> non-transforming; units transform	Fields/spacetime dynamical
Origination vs change	Name-form originates at <i>vyavahara</i> ; Brahman does not begin	No origination from <i>abhava</i> ; development and awakening	Local systems begin/end; substrate unsettled

This is the full doctrinal comparison. §5.5.2’s Primary Causation row cross-references it rather than repeating it.

5.5 Entity comparison

The tables below expand the framing answers of §5.2 into primary entities, now with Contemporary Philosophy and Modern Science in separate columns where those traditions diverge in entity type. Abrahamic and Dvaita ontologies are outside scope.

The six entities split into two groups: what each tradition takes as foundational (ground, self, matter), and how each tradition connects those foundations to the living world (relationships, causation, purpose). Each cell states the core commitment; fuller treatment of any position is in the section cited.

5.5.1 Ground, self, and matter

Entity Category	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy	Modern Science
Cosmic Ground	Omnipresence (<i>Satta</i>): pervasive, formless, actionless energy (<i>kriya-shunya</i>); units draw inherent energy and regulation through saturation (<i>samprikt</i>) — uniform energy becomes activity only through units (§1.2).	Brahman: the sole non-dual absolute reality (<i>Sat-Chit-Ananda</i>); the world is <i>mithya</i> (dependent appearance) at <i>paramartha</i> (§2.2).	No single ground; closest analogues are Spinoza’s one substance, Leibniz’s monad field, and process “creativity” (§§3.6.2–3.6.4).	Spacetime and quantum fields: dynamic physical substrate, no inherent consciousness or teleology (§4.4).

Entity Category	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy	Modern Science
Individual Self / Sentience	<i>Jeevan</i> : constitutionally complete, immortal atom (<i>gathanpurna parmanu</i>); many distinct, eternal units exist (§1.6.1).	<i>Jivatman / Atman</i> : individuality is a <i>vyavahara</i> superimposition (VC, v. 244); the true Self is identical to Brahman.	Self as form of the living body (hylomorphism), immortal monad (Leibniz), evolved self-model (physicalism), or Φ -threshold system (IIT) (§§3.6.1, 3.6.3, 3.4).	Predictive self-model / cognitive agent: brain-generated hierarchical model; no survival post-death (§4.1).
Material Reality / Body	<i>Jada</i> units / <i>shareer</i> : real, perpetual, transforming matter; composes the body, <i>jeevan</i> 's vehicle (§1.3).	<i>Nama-roopa / mithya</i> : form and name, robust at <i>vyavahara</i> , sublated at <i>paramartha</i> (§2.4).	Primary concrete reality (physicalism), or the outer aspect of experiential units (panpsychism).	Matter and energy: excitations of quantum fields, governed by conservation laws (§4.4).

5.5.2 Relationships, causation, and purpose

Entity Category	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy	Modern Science
Relationships & Moral Order	Coexistence / complementarity: ontologically real values (<i>mulya</i>) and orderliness (<i>vyavastha</i>) through the regulation ladder (§1.11).	Ethics at <i>vyavahara</i> : valid to purify the mind; <i>loka-sangraha</i> (BG); sublated at <i>paramartha</i> (§2.10).	Relationality constitutes the self (process), or relations are evolutionary survival strategies (physicalism).	Ecology and cooperation: interdependent biological networks; cooperation as an evolved behavioural strategy (§4.6).
Primary Causation	<i>Satta</i> as sustaining, not efficient, cause; units transform through the <i>shram-gati-parinam</i> triad — full doctrine comparison in §5.4.	<i>Vivartavada</i> : apparent transformation on changeless Brahman, on a <i>satkaryavada</i> background — §5.4.	Efficient causation (physicalism) or “conrescence” (process) — §5.4.	Mathematical laws, conservation, entropy — §5.4.

Entity Category	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy	Modern Science
Ultimate Purpose / Realisation	Awakening (<i>jagriti</i>): realisation of coexistence expressed as resolved humane conduct (<i>manaviya aacharan</i>) (§1.15).	Liberation (<i>moksha</i>): recognition of identity with Brahman; illusion of separate self dispelled (VC, v. 574).	Flourishing / adaptation (physicalism), or intensity of experience in each occasion (process).	Survival and adaptation: natural selection, active inference / free-energy minimisation (Friston 2010; §4.1).

5.6 The Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast, distributed

Advaita's Sat-Chit-Ananda and Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence can sound alike — both speak of being, consciousness, and fulfilment. The contrast is over what those words name and whether the world survives them, expanding the Cosmic Ground and Individual Self rows of §5.5.1 (see also §§5.3.1–5.3.3).

For Advaita, *sat*, *chit*, *ananda* are three names for one ultimate reality without a second; the world is finally *mithya*. For Madhyasth Darshan, the same vocabulary is distributed across coexistence, not compressed into one subject:

Concept	Advaita Vedanta (Unified Non-Dualism)	Madhyasth Darshan (Distributed Coexistence)
Sat (Being)	Brahman alone is Sat; the world is a dependent appearance ultimately negated.	Beingness (<i>astitva</i>) is coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless real units.
Chit (Consciousness)	Pure awareness, identical to the inner Self; the world of names/forms is inert.	Omnipresence is pervasive knowledge/condition-of-intelligibility (§1.2), but active sentience (<i>chaitanya</i>) belongs to the <i>jeevan</i> unit.
Ananda (Bliss)	Intrinsic nature of Brahman; sensory joy is a distorted reflection.	Harmony realised within awakened <i>jeevan</i> — bliss as buddhi- <i>atma</i> harmony and humane conduct — not Brahman's intrinsic <i>ananda</i> alone (§1.8).

The *chit* row and the DDV route sharpen a further fork. Both traditions refuse to reduce the first person to observed brain-states; both distinguish seer from seen. Advaita's *Sakshin* / *turiya*, once discriminated, is Brahman itself — impersonal, universal, and finally without a second knower. Madhyasth Darshan's knower is constitutionally complete *jeevan*: many distinct units, each capable of *gyan udghatan* when awakened (§1.7). Against physicalism the two stand together; against each other the dispute is whether irreducible awareness is one or many, impersonal ground or immortal persons-in-coexistence.

Modern philosophy has no parallel formula: it may treat experience as physical, fundamental, or illusory, but it does not name existence as Sat-Chit-Ananda or as coexistence.

5.7 Advaita structural fork: analogues and unmappable categories

Advaita Vedanta and Madhyasth Darshan arise from different core commitments — non-dualism versus co-existentialism — yet share Upanishadic vocabulary. Four Advaita entities find close analogues in Madhyasth Darshan; several further categories Advaita requires have no Madhyasth counterpart. Surface parallels should not obscure the fork: Advaita is world-subordinating non-dualism; Madhyasth Darshan is relational realism affirming eternal distinct *jeevan* and perpetual *jagat*.

The four analogue pairs, before the detail in §§5.7.1–5.7.4:

Advaita category	Madhyasth Darshan analogue	Shared ground	Where they diverge
Brahman	<i>Satta</i> (Omnipresence)	Formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, timeless, actionless	Brahman is the <i>sole</i> absolute reality (world <i>mithya</i>); <i>Satta</i> coexists with real nature (§5.7.1)
<i>Atman</i> / <i>Paramatman</i>	<i>Jeevan</i> (immortal sentient unit; <i>atma</i> as nucleus)	Immortal, non-material core of the self	One universal Self vs. many permanently distinct, active <i>jeevan</i> units (§5.7.2)
<i>Jiva</i> / deluded <i>jeevan</i>	<i>Jiva</i> / <i>bhramit jeevan</i>	Individual embodied self, bound by ignorance, seeking liberation or resolution	Duality is finally false and dissolves at realisation vs. individuality is ontologically real and persists through it (§5.7.3)
<i>Jagat</i> / name-form	Nature / units (<i>prakriti</i> / <i>ikai</i>)	The physical universe of change, bodies, name, and form	<i>Jagat</i> is ultimately <i>mithya</i> and sublated vs. <i>jagat</i> is <i>satat</i> — perpetual and eternally real (§5.7.4)

Categories Advaita needs with no Madhyasth counterpart — *Maya*, *adhyasa*, *mithya*, personal Ishvara, *kaivalya* — are treated separately in §5.7.5; forcing them into the table above would misstate an asymmetry as a parallel.

5.7.1 Brahman and *Satta*

The shared ground is formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, timeless, and actionless. The divergence is decisive: Advaita's Brahman is the *sole* absolute reality (*paramartha*), making the world dependent appearance (*mithya*); Madhyasth Darshan's *Satta* coexists with nature (*prakriti*), both real. Brahman is awareness itself (*chit*); *Satta* is actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*) — the condition of intelligibility — while active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs exclusively to the *jeevan* unit (§1.2).

5.7.2 Atman, Paramatman, and Jeevan

Both traditions point to an immortal, non-material core of the self. Advaita holds that the true Self (*Atman*) is exactly identical to the single, universal Supreme Self (*Paramatman*). Madhyasth Darshan denies a single universal self; *jeevan* units are permanently distinct, multiple, and active. Within *jeevan*, *atma* names the nuclear faculty of realisation — not a second name for Advaita’s universal Self.

Five-layer (*kosha*) language from the Upanishads is shared terminologically, not ontologically. Madhyasth Darshan carries two five-fold structures that do not match Advaita’s sheaths one-to-one: five inseparable faculties within *jeevan* and developmental planes (animal and deluded humans at four koshas; awakened humans at five including *vigyanmaya*; MVD, pp. 49–50; §§1.7, 1.9). Advaita peels sheaths away to reveal the Self beneath (VC, vv. 210, 639); Madhyasth Darshan affirms layered human equipment to be harmonised in awakened living. Listing koshas among structural analogues would overstate the parallel.

5.7.3 Jiva and deluded Jeevan

Both name the individual embodied self bound by ignorance and body-identification. In Advaita, the *jivatman*–*Paramatman* duality is maintained only at *vyavahara* through conditioning (*upadhis*); upon liberation the duality is seen to have been false — what remains is Brahman alone (CU 6.8.7; BS 1.1.2 with Śaṅkara’s bhāṣya; VC, v. 244). For Madhyasth Darshan, individuality is ontologically real and eternal; realisation (*jagriti*) resolves delusion but preserves the active, distinct individuality of the *jeevan*.

5.7.4 Jagat, name-form, and units

Both point to the physical universe of change, bodies, name, and form. In Advaita, the Jagat is ultimately *mithya* and sublated at the highest realisation. In Madhyasth Darshan, the world of units is *sat* (perpetual) and eternally real.

5.7.5 Categories Advaita needs that Madhyasth Darshan rejects

Several central Advaita categories have no Madhyasth equivalent because co-existentialism explicitly rejects them.

Advaita’s *Maya* is the cosmic power that conceals Brahman (*avarana*) and projects the illusion of the world (*vikshepa*). Madhyasth Darshan has no cosmic power or substance of illusion. Ignorance (*agnyan* / *bhrama*) is the temporary cognitive absence of understanding — lack of awakening — resolved through study and education, not a force projecting unreality.

In Advaita, the world is superimposed (*adhyasa*) on Brahman like a snake on a rope (BS 2.1.14 with Śaṅkara’s bhāṣya; VC, v. 20). Madhyasth Darshan has no ontological superimposition. The relationship between units and *Satta* is saturation (*samprikt*) — real, mutual, non-reductive co-location (§1.2; SB, pp. 57, 62, 69) — not projection or false attribution. Do not confuse this with Madhyasth Darshan’s homonym *adhyasa* in the animal order — species-traditional inertial-impression from gestation (§1.5; SB, pp. 62–63) — which names conduct-pattern inheritance.

Advaita's *mithya* (*sad-asad-anirvacaniya* — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing) describes the world's dependent appearance (CU 6.2.1–6.2.2 with Śāṅkara's *bhāṣya*; VC, v. 251; §§2.4–2.5). Madhyasth Darshan rejects any intermediate ontological status: everything that exists is real, perpetual, and indestructible.

In Advaita, Ishvara is Brahman associated with *Maya* — operative cause of name-form manifestation, sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244), not a personal creator *ex nihilo*. Madhyasth Darshan rejects Ishvara in this sense — a cosmic governor who plans, acts as efficient cause, or dispenses grace. That is not rejection of transcendence altogether: MVD's ninth Reality set includes “God is omnipresent, deities are many” (proposition 5; §1.14) — *God* names actionless Omnipresence (*satta*), while deities are many denies elevating personal deities to ultimate status. Orderliness (*vyavastha*) is self-regulation (*swatah-sasput*) inherent in the co-existing orders (§1.11); *Satta* remains actionless (*kriya-shunya*).

Advaita seeks *kaivalya* — recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman (*jiva-brahma-aikya*), in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled (*tat tvam asi*, CU 6.8.7; BS 1.1.2; VC, vv. 244, 574). Madhyasth Darshan holds that individual *jeevan* units remain eternally distinct; the ultimate goal is awakened coexistence (*jagriti*) — active *jeevan* in harmonious relationships (*sambandh*) with other humans and the ecological orders.

While surface-level analogues exist, the core ontological commitments are ultimately irreconcilable. A true one-to-one mapping is impossible without distorting the foundational claims of either system.

The alliances of §5.1 therefore stand: the traditions share pairwise agreements and deny one another on matter-only reduction, final world-weight, and immortal individuality. Open problems for Madhyasth Darshan, and critical review of Advaita and modern approaches, follow in §6.

6. Critical Review

Comparison in §5 named the forks. This section asks what still holds under pressure: whether Madhyasth Darshan coheres on its own terms, which problems remain open inside it, and what Advaita and modern approaches gain and lose against that picture.

6.1 Internal coherence of the Madhyasth Darshan position

Judged on its own definitions — not as proof against rivals — the ontology hangs together. Coexistence, real units, and beginninglessness form one picture without separate doctrines for each question (§§5.2–5.3). “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual” preserves the reality of nature, society, relationship, and ethical responsibility rather than sublating the world; consciousness, value, and selfhood are not treated as mere byproducts of body-chemistry.

If existence is coexistence, human fulfilment must be evidenced as coexistence in behaviour, not merely believed. “Nothing existent is annihilated” gives internal coherence to *vastu* persisting through *roop*-change and bodily death as configuration-shift — though post-death continuity of *this jeevan* is a further metaphysical commitment, not a theorem of quantity conservation alone (§1.14, §6.2.3).

These are strengths within the system's premises. They do not by themselves establish those premises against Advaita or physicalism (§§6.2–6.4).

6.2 Open problems for Madhyasth Darshan

Three pressures remain open. They concern public identification and comparison, not a need to replace the account given in the primary texts.

6.2.1 Constitutional completeness and public identification

Madhyasth Darshan gives a definite account of the sentience threshold. An evolving-constitution atom remains under molecular and weight bondage; through contraction and expansion it becomes free from those bondages, its particle constitution closes, and it becomes the hope-bound sentient atom called *jeevan* (MVD, p. 91; SB, pp. 55, 59, 114). This is not a claim that experience was latent in Omnipotence, nor that enough biological complexity produces a mind. Omnipotence remains actionless; the knower is *jeevan*. The darshan locates a qualitative transition within development in the atom and distinguishes it from the compositional progression that produces molecules, cells, and bodies (§§1.6–1.7).

The account is therefore clearer and more internally specific than a generic appeal to emergence. Its open problem is comparative and evidential: the texts do not provide a public procedure for identifying the proposed closed particle constitution, release from weight bondage, or hope-bondage in the terms used by contemporary physics and chemistry. A resemblance to thresholds in emergentism or integrated-information theories does not establish identity, because those theories locate their thresholds in organised systems rather than in a distinct constitutionally complete atom (§§3.3, 4.2). Further work should seek discriminating observations or state clearly that *gathanpurnata* is known through the darshan's study-and-realisation method rather than through an existing physical measurement.

6.2.2 Persistence and the *jeevan*–body joint form

Quantity conservation alone does not establish personal survival: physics may conserve mass-energy or charge while an organised system loses its identity. The primary MD case for *jeevan*'s persistence, however, does not rest on conservation alone. It adds constitutional completeness: the constitution is closed, no longer undergoes further compositional change, and is free from molecular and weight bondage (MVD, p. 91; SB, pp. 55, 59, 114). JV's statement that *jeevan* continues after bodily death and can work through another body (JV, pp. 20, 54) presupposes this account. The claim should therefore be presented as a consequence of *gathanpurnata* within MD, not as an inference from a generic physical conservation law (§§1.8, 1.14).

The remaining question is whether this persisting unit and its reassociation can be independently evidenced. Madhyasth Darshan describes the human as a joint form: the body is a material instrument, *jeevan* is the sentient seer–doer–enjoyer, and the two operate together through the body's nervous and sensory organisation (MVD, pp. 115, 288–289; SB, pp. 91–92). Since *jeevan* is described as an atom rather than a Cartesian non-physical substance, the issue should not be prejudged as an injection of energy from outside nature. Yet the texts do not translate the joint operation into measurements that distinguish *jeevan*-mediated activity from a brain-only account. The productive question is thus the missing operational bridge between the primary-text description and neuroscience, including what observation could count for or against post-death continuity.

6.2.3 Evidence standards and evolutionary scope

Madhyasth Darshan does not limit evidence to assertion or private conviction. Its method moves through study, self-examination, practice, realisation, and evidence in conduct; understanding is expected to become intersubjectively visible as resolution, justice, mutual fulfilment, and participation in orderliness (MVD, pp. 88, 115; SB, p. 44; §§1.13, 5.3.5). This is a substantial practical evidence standard. It is not, by itself, a physical detection procedure for constitutional completeness, a persisting atomic *jeevan*, or post-death reassociation. The paper should therefore keep logical grounding, first-person verification, conduct evidence, and instrument-based scientific confirmation distinct. Comparisons with physics are appropriately described as parallels or tensions unless a shared operational criterion has been established.

The apparent conflict between *niyati-kram* and evolutionary contingency also needs narrowing. MD's progression names an ordered relation among material, bio, animal, and knowledge orders, while evolutionary biology explains branching changes within living populations through variation, inheritance, selection, and contingency (§§1.5, 4.6). These claims are not direct contradictories merely because one uses definite order language and the other uses contingency: they operate at different descriptive levels. The sharper questions are whether MD requires each transition to occur necessarily, how its compositional claims map onto biological descent, and what evidence would distinguish a necessary existential progression from a retrospective classification of the forms that happened to arise. Until that mapping is supplied, *niyati-kram* remains a distinctive commitment of the darshan rather than a result established by evolutionary science.

6.3 Advaita — strengths and limits

Strengths. Advaita answers non-being rigorously (existence cannot arise from non-existence, CU 6.2.2) and offers a disciplined first-person method — DDV's seer-seen discrimination and MU's three-state analysis (§§2.1–2.7). Its ontology is parsimonious: one partless Brahman, without a second ground, without plural immortal substances. Ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and beginningless *vyavahara* (§2.10) make the empirical world robust for living; that defence should not be dismissed in a sentence.

Weaknesses. Making the world *mithya* at *paramartha* makes it harder to ground the final ontological weight of relationships, nature, society, and conduct (§2.4; §§5.6–5.7). Liberation as *jiva-brahma-aihya* dispels separate individuality (§§2.6, 5.3.3), whereas Madhyasth Darshan requires distinct immortal *jeevan* for relational realism and post-death continuity (§§1.7–1.8). *Maya*, *adhyasa*, *mithya*, and Brahman as *chit* do not map onto saturation, *jagat satat*, and *gyan* as intelligibility-ground (§§5.6–5.7.5). Nagraj presses the origination tension directly:

“According to Vedanta knowledge, only Brahma is the truth, and this world is an illusion (‘Brahma satya, jagat mithya’). However, jeeva and jagat are said to have originated from Brahma.”

- MVD, *The Alternative*

“How can the jeeva and jagat, which originated from the Truth, Knowledge, and Infinite Brahma, be an illusion?”

- MVD, *The Alternative*

Advaita’s reply — three-tier reality and *vivartavada* (VC, v. 251; §§2.4–2.5) — is coherent within Advaita; Madhyasth Darshan denies that sublation is the last word. Beginningless *vyavahara* does not settle final ontological status: *satat* names a world that retains full weight at the highest realisation (§5.7). Plurality buys that realism at a cost of ontological complexity Advaita refuses; Advaita’s cost is world-subordination at the highest truth. Neither system is free of trade-offs.

6.4 Modern approaches — strengths and limits

Strengths. Modern approaches are strongest where Madhyasth Darshan is weakest: public evidence, empirical correction, cognitive modelling, and precise mechanism. Self-model theory and predictive processing explain embodied selfhood and regulation without an eternal *jeevan* (§4.1); illusionism shows how far naturalism will go to preserve a physicalist frame. Scientific realism’s mind-independent world allies with Madhyasth Darshan against final world-subordination (§5.1, §5.3.2). Predictive processing deserves the same seriousness as Advaita’s *loka-sangraha* defence: it meets MD partway on embodiment and circular causation, and is a harder opponent than bare eliminativism.

Weaknesses. The hard problem remains: correlation of brain and experience is not disputed, but why any physical process should have an inside at all is open (§3.2), and rival consciousness programs lack consensus (§4.2). That is not proof of *jeevan* — it marks where matter-only ontology still owes an account of experience. Against immortal *jeevan*, causal closure (§3.1) and brain death as the operational end of the person (§4.1) are genuine pressures (§6.2.2). Public science would require operational criteria for constitutional completeness, reproducible markers distinguishing *jeevan*–body operation from a brain-only account, and independent evidence for post-death continuity; until then, immortal *jeevan* remains a metaphysical commitment not publicly confirmed by current science. Predictive models explain how a body self-regulates; they do not settle whether the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct sentient unit (§5.3.5, §6.2.1). Modern philosophy is not unified — Chalmers, Nagel, and Strawson show experience resists reduction — and has not proved that the self is only the brain. What it has established is a high evidential bar: an explanatory gap is not an existence proof for *jeevan*.

7. Conclusion

Madhyasth Darshan’s distinctive claim is coexistence: formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless real units (*ikai*), beginningless and neither made from the other, with the world retaining final weight.

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.”

- MVD, p. 13

The three fault lines of §5.1 still organise the comparison. Against physicalism, Madhyasth Darshan refuses matter-only reduction while keeping the world fully real for study and responsibility. Against Advaita, it refuses final world-subordination: perpetual *jagat*, distinct immortal *jeevan*, and ontologically real relationships and values (*mulya*) retain weight at the highest truth. Against both, it holds relational realism tied to conduct — understanding fulfilled when coexistence is evident in humane living.

What remains open is not the map of alliances but the bridge between Madhyasth Darshan’s internally articulated account and other methods of inquiry: public identification of constitutional completeness (§6.2.1), independent evidence for *jeevan*’s persistence and joint operation with the body (§6.2.2), and a careful separation of conduct evidence from physical measurement together with a clearer mapping to evolutionary explanation (§6.2.3). Those are the points at which further work must press, not where this study claims settlement.

Appendix: Quick Glossary

Key terms from §§1–4 are collected here for quick reference. Each term is also defined where it first appears in the exposition.

Terms in §1

Term	Plain meaning
Coexistence (<i>saha-astitva</i>)	Reality as the pervasive ground (<i>satta</i>) and all units (<i>ikai</i>) inseparably present together — beginningless, without creation from nothing.
Satta (Omnipresence)	The formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming ground in which all units are saturated. See Editorial Notes on translation conventions.
Unit (<i>ikai</i>)	A countable, bounded entity in nature — insentient (<i>jada</i>) or sentient (<i>chaitanya</i>).
Saturation (<i>samprikt</i>)	The ever-present bond in which each unit is soaked, submerged, and surrounded in Omnipresence; from saturated bounded plurality three endowments follow in every unit — recognition capability for complementarity, activeness, and inherent regulation (§1.2).
Effort–motion–result (<i>shram–gati–parinam</i>)	The inseparable triad of unit-activity powered by saturation, identical to the unit’s existence. In the sentient atom, result (<i>parinam</i>) seeks the goal of immortality (<i>amarta</i>) at constitutional completeness; effort (<i>shram</i>) seeks the goal of restfulness (<i>vishram</i>) at activity completeness; and motion (<i>gati</i>) seeks the goal of destination (<i>gantavya</i>) at conduct completeness (SB pp. 58, 71; MVD p. 104).

Term	Plain meaning
Immortality of result (<i>parinam ki amarta</i>)	The teleological goal of result (<i>parinam</i>) at constitutional completeness (T1 / <i>gathanpurnata</i>) — permanent stabilisation of the atom's physical structure (§1.6).
Restfulness of effort (<i>shram ka vishram</i>)	The teleological goal of effort (<i>shram</i>) at activity completeness (T2 / <i>kriyapurnata</i>) — internal cognitive seeking resolves into realisation and <i>samadhan</i> ; not relational ease in §1.3 (§1.6).
Destination of motion (<i>gati ka gantavya</i>)	The teleological goal of motion (<i>gati</i>) at conduct completeness (T3 / <i>acharanpurnata</i>) — external behavioural participation aligned with universal orderliness (§1.6).
The four orders (<i>chaar avastha</i>)	Material, bio/pranic, animal, and knowledge/human — real developmental plateaus in nature.
Relationship (<i>sambandh</i>)	Definite mutuality with expectations predetermined toward completeness (MVD p. 62).
Law (ontological)	Orderliness and regulation read from saturation — universal across all four orders; not statutory command.
<i>Jeevan</i>	The sentient self: a constitutionally complete, immortal unit — <i>atma</i> as nucleus, <i>buddhi–mun</i> as orbital structure — that works through the body (§1.7).
Constitutional completeness (<i>gathanpurnata</i>)	When a developed atom integrates its required particles and crosses irreversibly into sentient <i>jeevan</i> (Transition 1, T1).
Existential progression (<i>niyati-kram</i>)	Fixed macro sequence in nature: pranic order from material, animal from pranic, knowledge/human from animal — not contingent reordering of plateaus (§1.9).
Way of existence (<i>niyati-vidhi</i>)	Definiteness in the conduct of each of the four orders; paired with <i>niyati-kram</i> (order emergence ↔ order conduct; §1.11).
Development progression (<i>vikas-kram</i>)	Atomic-level movement through the physicochemical complex until an atom reaches constitutional completeness and sentient <i>jeevan</i> appears (§1.9).
Awakening progression (<i>jagriti-kram</i>)	Sentient-level movement within constitutionally complete <i>jeevan</i> toward fuller activity and conduct (§1.9).
<i>Jeevan</i> values (<i>sukh, shanti, santosh, anand</i>)	Four felt harmonies within <i>jeevan</i> — happiness, peace, contentment, bliss — organised through faculty pairs (§1.8).

Term	Plain meaning
Utility value (<i>upyogita</i>)	Usefulness of natural abundance made available through labour; definite and constant across time (JV p. 123).
Art value (<i>kala</i>)	Aesthetic enhancement of utility — beautification along with usefulness (MVD p. 324).
Human values	Values of humane living grasped through coexistence understanding and humane conduct (JV pp. 44, 139); one of six value kinds (§1.4).
Established values	Relationship values — care, trust, affection, and the like — that flow when relationships are recognised (JV pp. 108, 138; §1.4).
Expression values	Right-use of body, mind, and wealth in the social order; <i>civic values</i> in Gupta’s English (MVD p. 306; §1.4).
Gyan (ground)	In analytical prose, intelligibility in <i>satta</i> — the saturated coexistence of ground and units (§1.2; Editorial Notes). Distinct from Realisation Knowledge (<i>anubhav jnan</i>), <i>gyan udghatan</i> , and the knowledge order name (<i>gyan-avastha</i>).
Evaluative domain	Conduct, thought, or realisation — the three humane perspectives discipline distinct domains (§1.12).
Sentient mode	How effort–motion–result maps once constitutional completeness is reached — distinct from insentient unit-activity (§1.6).

Further terms — planes, justice, prosperity — are defined where they first appear in §1.

Terms in §2

Term	Plain meaning
Brahman	The sole absolute reality — being, consciousness, bliss (<i>sat-chit-ananda</i>), one without a second.
Nirguna	Attribute-free Brahman at <i>paramartha</i> — actionless, not an object among objects.
Saguna	Brahman associated with Maya and spoken of as Ishvara — operative at <i>vyavahara</i> .
Paramartha	Absolute level of truth; Brahman alone is absolutely real.
Vyavahara	Shared empirical order — bodies, law, ethics, scripture; robust but sublated at highest realisation.
Pratibhasika	Private apparent error (rope-snake, dream objects); sublated by correction.

Term	Plain meaning
Mithya	Dependent appearance — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing; valid at <i>vyavahara</i> , sublated at <i>paramartha</i> .
Maya	Cosmic power of concealment (<i>avarana</i>) and projection (<i>vikshepa</i>); Ishvara's superimposition on Brahman.
Avidya	Individual ignorance — the jiva's superimposition of body-mind on the Self.
Adhyasa	Superimposition — attributing what belongs to one level to another (snake on rope).
Adhyaropa–apavada	Provisional attribution then withdrawal — teaching by admitting name-form and later negating it.
Satkaryavada	The effect pre-exists in the cause (clay already in the pot).
Vivartavada	Apparent transformation — Brahman does not change; name-form is projected.
Upadhi	Limiting adjunct conditioning the Self (body, mind, sheaths).
Pratibimba / Avaccheda	Reflection and limitation — classical accounts of how one Self appears as many jivas under adjuncts.
Sthula / Sukshma / Karana	Gross, subtle, and causal bodies — the empirical person's three-body stack.
Pancha kosha	Five sheaths (food, vital, mental, intellect, bliss) conditioning the embodied self at <i>vyavahara</i> .
Srishti–sthiti–laya	Manifestation, maintenance, and dissolution — beginningless empirical cycles, not a single absolute beginning.
Turiya	The “fourth” — witness-consciousness beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep.
Sakshin	Witness — the seer that is never itself an object of perception.
Moksha	Liberation — recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman, not merger of a real individual.
Jivanmukti / Videhamukti	Liberation while living, and liberation completed with the fall of the body.
Karma / Samsara	Empirical continuity of the conditioned person across births until knowledge dispels separateness.

Terms in §3

Term	Plain meaning
Physicalism	The view that every real, concrete phenomenon is physical — minds and selves are processes or organisations of physical systems.
Causal closure	Every physical event has a sufficient physical cause; no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the physical order (Kim 2005).
Hard problem	Why and how physical processes give rise to subjective experience — the “something it is like” (Chalmers 1995; Nagel 1974).
Panpsychism	Experience is fundamental or ubiquitous in nature; wholly non-experiential matter cannot produce experience (Strawson 2006).
Combination problem	If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into one unified macro-subject?
Illusionism	Phenomenal consciousness as usually conceived is a misdescription; only access-consciousness and functional states exist (Frankish 2016).
Personal identity	What makes a person the same individual over time — psychological continuity (Locke), reductionism (Parfit), or substance (soul, monad).
Scientific realism	The physical world exists mind-independently and is the proper object of public inquiry.
Neutral monism	Mind and matter are composed of a common neutral stuff, neither mental nor material in isolation (Russell 1921; Mach 1914).
<i>Samadhanatmak bhautikvad</i>	Resolution Centred Materialism — MD’s reframing of materialism: real matter saturated in Omnipresence, not consciousness-from-matter or matter-only reduction (SB).

Terms in §4

Term	Plain meaning
Self-model	The brain’s internal representation of the organism as a unified subject — not an immortal unit but a regulative construct (Metzinger 2003).
Predictive processing / active inference	The brain as a hierarchical generative model minimizing prediction error; selfhood as functionally real control structure (Friston 2010; Clark 2016).
Integrated information (Φ)	IIT’s measure of how much a system’s cause–effect structure is irreducible; consciousness tied to a structural threshold (Tononi 2012).

Term	Plain meaning
Autopoiesis	Living organisation as a self-producing network maintaining its boundary through metabolism (Maturana and Varela 1980).
ΛCDM	Standard cosmological model: cold dark matter plus dark energy; hot big bang ~13.8 billion years ago.
Quantum field	In QFT, what persists are fields; particles are localized excitations, not tiny enduring substances (Weinberg 1995).
Brain death	Operational criterion for end of personhood in medicine — irreversible loss of whole-brain function.
Entropy	Thermodynamic tendency toward disorder in closed systems; distinct from MD’s orderliness (<i>vyavastha</i>) at every order.
Natural selection	Differential reproduction of heritable traits; mainstream mechanism for biological adaptation and cooperation.

Editorial Notes

Translation and editorial conventions (*satta*)

The source texts’ primary English term for the all-pervasive, formless reality (*satta*) is Omnipotence; *vyapak* (“all-pervasive”) is rendered “Omnipresence” in the English translation. The English translation alternates Omnipotence and Omnipresence for the same *satta*; Hindi *satta* is the constant behind both. To avoid the theistic connotations of “Omnipotence,” the study uses “Omnipresence” as its running English term in analytical prose. Block quotes preserve whichever word the translation prints. Where Hindi *shunya* appears, the translation renders it Space — void/emptiness (actionless, formless), not physical *akasha*.

Gyan in analytical prose

In analytical prose, **gyan** names coexistence as the complete intelligible content — nature saturated in *satta* (§1.2) — not a mind that knows, and not a property of a reified bond between ground and units. *Satta* is actionless; projection (*paravartan*) and reflection (*pratyavartan*) name *jeevan*’s faculty activities (§1.7), and sentience is predicated of the constitutionally complete atom, never of the ground (§1.6.1). Where the texts use a distinct compound or order name, this study keeps it explicit: Realisation Knowledge (*anubhav jnan*) for orderliness evident in every unit (§1.1); *gyan udghatan* for knowledge unfolding through awakened *jeevan* (§1.7); knowledge order (*gyan-avastha*) for the fourth order of nature, named for human knowing, not for Omnipresence-as-knower (§1.5).

Analytical vocabulary: sense, domain, mode

The source texts reuse words — *gyan*, *nyaya*, law — at more than one level of meaning. Conflating those levels is a common source of misreading. The default use of *gyan* is stated above; domain names conduct, thought, and realisation — and regulation, justice, and statute — in §1.12; mode or level marks a qualitative threshold (sentience, emergence) where the darshan requires it. Register is reserved for ordinary English (*registers as happiness, activity registers on another*) and for quoted source usage — not as a standalone analytical label. Where the study names the completeness drive’s **termination condition** (development bound until realisation in *satta*) or an **epistemic gradient** (from being-in-knowledge toward knowing), those are analytical glosses on SB and MVD phrasing in §§1.2 and 1.6 — not separate doctrines.

“Consciousness” in SB p. 48

The English translation lists several names for the pervasive reality (*Satta / Vyapak*): Uniform Energy, Space (*shunya*), Knowledge (*gyan*), Consciousness, Omnipresence, Eternity, God, and Absolute Energy. In SB p. 48, the parenthetical “(consciousness)” labels the all-pervasive reality, not a personal knowing mind. Sentience as the activity of a knower (*chaitanya*) is the status of *jeevan* (the sentient unit), not of Omnipresence (*satta*) itself. This distinction is essential; the comparative risk of collapsing *satta-as-gyan* into Advaita’s *chit* is addressed in §§1.1–1.2 and 5.7.1.

Naming tensions for *satta*

The source gives *satta* multiple English names. Several generate internal tensions if treated as interchangeable:

Name	Tension
Knowledge / Consciousness	Implies cognition — yet <i>satta</i> is denied as knower (§1.2).
Space / <i>Shunya</i>	Void/emptiness vs. fullness of energy; <i>shunya</i> is rendered “Space” in the English translation, not physical <i>akasha</i> .
God	Personhood vs. actionless, non-willing <i>satta</i> .
Absolute Energy	Dynamism vs. <i>kriya-shunya</i> (actionless).
Uniform Energy, Eternity	Listed alongside the names above; no single English label captures all aspects.

The source does not fully settle how these names cohere as one reality.

Advaita: *mithya* and *sad-asad-anirvacaniya*

The *mithya* doctrine and Advaita’s three-tier framework (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*) are related but distinct tools; §2 keeps them apart. The compound *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* is a post-Shankara

systematic term (Vimuktatman, Vivarana school); Shankara uses “neither sat nor asat” language without that compound.

Advaita: *Vivekachudamani* as source

This study cites the *Vivekachudamani* (VC) heavily for accessible verse formulations of discrimination, ethics, and liberation. VC is a devotional *prakriya* (method) text traditionally attributed to Shankara; modern scholarship treats that authorship as uncertain. The Upanishads, *Mandukya*, and DDV supply the exegetical core; VC supplies pedagogical compression. Claims tied to VC should be read as standard Advaita teaching in that genre, not as a substitute for Brahma Sutra commentary on disputed points.

References

Section 1

- **Paribhasha** — Nagraj, A. [*Paribhasha Samhita*](#). Hindi, ed. 2008. English selection of definitions at madhyasth.org. Cited: Standpoint; §1.5 (*niyati-kram, niyati-vidhi*).
- **KD** — Nagraj, A. [*Manav Karm Darshan*](#). Hindi, v5. Working English: [*KD-Karm-Darshan-English*](#) (not a published translation; paraphrase only in §1 unless Hindi-verified). Cited: §§1.1–1.2, 1.6–1.8, 1.13 (atom as root quantity; endowment chain; two developments; hungry/undigested/satisfied; three stages scoped to *jeevan*; seer–doer–enjoyer; projection–reflection; karma as activity with aspiration; five limbs; desire–karma–result balance; spiral of widening evidence).
- **§1 (introduction)**. Existence as coexistence of Omnipotence (*satta*) and units of nature, insentient (*jada*) and sentient (*chaitanya*): SB pp. 48–49; MVD pp. 11, 34. Continuous seeking of happiness; four stages of happiness: MVD p. 163. Societal telos (fearlessness, prosperity, trust, undivided society): MVD p. 160 ff.; JV p. 61; §§1.15–1.16 references below.
- **§1.1**. Two-pole structure: “What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present. Upon examining their fundamental nature, we learn that all of existence is essentially nature (matter) saturated in Omnipotence (consciousness). Here, ‘seeing’ is intended in the sense of understanding. Since nature saturated in Omnipotence is inseparably present, existence itself is eternally manifest in the form of coexistence.” (SB, p. 48). Omnipotence as actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*), ground of energising, regulation, conservation: SB pp. 48–49. English names for *satta* (Uniform Energy, Space / *shunya*, Knowledge / *gyan*, Consciousness, Absolute Energy): SB p. 48. Units bounded from six directions; four-aspect signature; Realisation Knowledge (*anubhav jnan*): SB p. 48; MVD pp. 11, 34. Atom as root of physical, chemical, and *jeevan* activity; nucleus and orbits as root quantity: KD 3.1; MVD pp. 42, 78, 149. Separation “never happens”: SB p. 70; JV p. 18. No absent place: SB pp. 48, 62, 69. Inter-unit distance held in *satta* as Space: SB pp. 57, 59, 79. State-complete (*sthitipurn*) / state-dynamic (*sthitishil*): SB pp. 50, 68–69.

- **§1.2.** Saturated (*samprikt*) — soaked, submerged, surrounded: SB pp. 48–49. Endowment chain (soaked → energy → force / magnetic force → recognition → orderliness): SB pp. 57, 61–62; KD 3.1. Recognition endowment: “Nature is recognisable in the state-complete Omnipotence with its countless unitness. Consequently, a provision for one unit to recognise another got manifest in existence.” (SB, p. 50); complementarity given in the bond: SB pp. 49–50, 53; bounded plurality provisions recognition: SB pp. 50, 57, 62; capacity (*kshamata*), ability (*yogyata*), receptivity (*patrata*): SB pp. 57, 62, 79; MVD p. 62; “transparent in mutuality”: MVD p. 32. Activeness endowment (forcefulness as force-side name of the same bond): “Every unit in its atomic state is active as orderliness, because it has inherent energy due to being saturated in Omnipotence.” (SB, p. 69); “Unit + Energy fullness = Activeness.” (SB, p. 69); “Thus, without basic impulsion, the energy remains unmanifest, and without the energy, there is no basic impulsion.” (SB, p. 62); “Without absolute energy, there is no basic impulsion in matter, and without matter, absolute energy is not revealed. Nature is eternally present in absolute energy.” (MVD, p. 40); activeness as testimony of permeativeness: MVD p. 32; JV p. 150; forcefulness and basic impulsion endowed: SB p. 57; activeness always with contact in mutuality: SB p. 62; effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*): “Since nature is eternally active within existence, every activity has inseparable effort, motion and result.” (SB, p. 53); also SB pp. 58, 69; MVD p. 40. Regulation endowment: MVD p. 26; SB p. 57. Saturation itself as knowledge: “Saturated (*samprikt*): – Insentient and sentient nature is submerged, soaked and surrounded in Omnipotence. This itself is coexistence, coexistence itself is eternal, and this itself is knowledge. Law, regulation, balance, justice, dharma and ultimate truth are evident in coexistence only.” (MVD, pp. 32–33). Completeness drive grounded in the endowments; conducive environments and naturalness: SB pp. 50–51.
- **§1.3.** Four aspects (form / *roop*, properties / *gun*, essential nature / *svabhav*, *dharma*): MVD pp. 50–51, 112; dharma as innateness and fulfilment: SB p. 50. Atom as root quantity with the four aspects: KD 3.9–3.10. Companion facts: “Each unit is a whole along with its environment.” (SB, p. 13); “Each unit is orderliness with its ness and participates in overall orderliness.” (SB, p. 13); “Each unit moves towards ‘development’ in its natural state and ‘decline’ in its excited state.” (SB, p. 14). Unit + environment signifies continuity: SB p. 51; *ness* shown through essential nature in natural state: SB p. 54. Natural/excited state: SB pp. 14–15; reinstatement of natural motion (*svabhav gati*) after give and take: SB p. 59. Recognition and fulfilment within an atom: SB p. 123; endeavour with/against innateness: MVD p. 112. Peepal tree: JV p. 113. Harmony of the four aspects as essence of coexistence: MVD p. 21.
- **§1.4.** “Nothing is isolated – that is the principle.” (JV, p. 43). Complementarity actualised as value in mutuality: SB p. 53. Relationship vs association: “the mutuality where expectations are predetermined in the sense of completeness” vs “the mutuality where expectations are voluntary” (MVD, pp. 61–62). Essentiality as value: “Entire beingness implies the essentiality of units in every plane and order. Essentiality refers to value... It is values that are reciprocated and mutually recognised, as complementarity, mutual recognition, and impression occur only in mutuality.” (SB, p. 50). Object values — utility (*upyogita*), art (*kala*): MVD p. 306; JV pp. 123, 138. Recognition and fulfilment: “Every entity of nature recognises another; that is why it fulfils.

An atomic particle too recognises another, and as a result, these particles abide in orderliness.” (JV, p. 69). Capacity, ability, receptivity developed through environment and interference: SB p. 61. Use, right-use, purposeful-use: MVD p. 27. Seed and naturalness: SB p. 54. Realisation in coexistence as fulfilment made evident: SB p. 51.

- **§1.5.** Four orders (*padarth, pran, jeev, gyan* avasthas); cumulative dharmas: SB p. 179; MVD p. 115. Order table (essential natures and dharmas — *sangathan–vighatan/astitva; sarak–marak/pushti*; cruel–uncruel/*jeene ki aasha*; six human values/*sukh*): SB p. 179; JV p. 44. Existence stable, development definite: MVD p. 5. Existential progression (*niyati-kram*): MVD pp. 8, 13 (term named in *Paribhasha Samhita*, ed. 2008). Reversion of biological to material order: SB pp. 76–78. Way of existence (*niyati-vidhi*) and conformance modes: SB pp. 62–63 (animal-order *adhyasa* as gestational inheritance of conduct-pattern; homonym caution vs Advaita’s *adhyasa*, §5.7.5). Statuses within matter and designed completeness stages: SB pp. 50–52, 78. Modes of manifestation per order; countlessness as practical uncountability: MVD p. 289; SB p. 49.
- **§1.6.** Span of the drive: “The nature saturated in the state-complete Omnipotence is oriented for development and awakening until realisation in Omnipotence. Development refers to constitutional completeness, activity completeness, and conduct completeness, along with their continuity. Awakening refers to resolution and authenticity.” (SB, p. 51). Existential-truth bound (nature bound for development until realised in Omnipotence; applies to insentient and sentient): SB p. 91. Two developments that must not be collapsed (compositional progression vs development in the atom; three stages scoped to the constitutionally complete *jeevan* atom): KD 3.2–3.3. Happiness → bliss as knowledge-order / sentient face of the same drive (felt ladder in §1.8; terminus as realisation in §1.13): JV p. 138; MVD p. 101; SB p. 51. Two atomic paths and projection/reflection: SB p. 60. Triad joint structure: “Every physical-chemical activity is an inseparable presence of effort, motion and result. Each of these is a joint form of the other two.” (SB, p. 58); sodium–chlorine illustration: SB p. 58. Internal unfolding chain: “Saturation in uniform energy itself is forcefulness, forcefulness itself is basic impulsion, basic impulsion itself is activity, activity itself is effort-motion-result, effort-motion-result itself is development and its continuity.” (SB, p. 62). Force in state, power in motion: SB pp. 248–249. Teleological goals: “In the sentient atom: Conduct completeness is in the form of destination of motion. Activity completeness is in the form of restfulness of effort. Constitutional completeness (the *jeevan* atom) is in the form of immortality of result.” (SB, p. 58); “The result is meant to attain the goal of immortality, the effort is meant to attain the goal of restfulness, motion is meant to attain the goal of destination. This goal itself becomes evident in the form of development progression and development.” (SB, p. 71); “...at the core of effort, motion and result, the study of immortality of result, restfulness of effort, and final-destination of motion is necessary...” (MVD, p. 104). Hindi terms for the transitions: *gathanpurnata, kriyapurnata, acharanpurnata*; goals: *parinam ki amarta, shram ka vishram, gati ka gantavya*.
- **§1.6.1.** Sentience threshold at atomic level: SB pp. 52, 92. Integration through hungry/undigested (overfull) complementarity: MVD p. 8; SB pp. 58, 71; KD 3.3 (hungry, undigested, satisfied; inexhaustible force). Closed particle constitution: SB p. 55. Crossing evidence: “An evolving-

constitution atom is with molecular-bondage and weight-bondage. However, when the contraction and expansion activity increases in this atom, it instantly breaks free from its group and attains constitutional completeness, becoming a jeevan atom. The evidence of constitutional completeness is the jeevan atom's liberation from molecular-bondage and weight-bondage, and its having the hope-bondage." (MVD, p. 91); also SB p. 114. Immortality of result evident as sentient jeevan: SB p. 59. Recognition upgraded to inner circuit: "...the recognition of taste, which could not become manifest in insentient nature, first became manifest in sentient nature. In sentient nature, the strength of mun expresses itself in the form of hope-power. Its activities are selection and taste-recognition." (SB, pp. 80–81).

- **§1.6.2.** Restfulness of effort; realisation (*anubhav*) and absolute resolution (*samadhan*) on the deific plane: SB p. 51; §1.6 above. "Absence of delusion itself is restfulness" (*nirbhramta hi vishram*): MVD, Ch. 5. Epistemic stall — body mistaken for jeevan: SB p. 91. Seer–doer–enjoyer (*drashta–karta–bhokta*); delusion as doer and enjoyer without seer; projection–reflection as T2 path: KD 3.12, 3.18.
- **§1.6.3.** Destination of motion; authentic conduct and living proof (*pramanikta*) in universal orderliness (*vyavastha*), mutual satisfaction and justice: MVD p. 80. Perceiver status (*drishta pad*) evidenced in orderliness with *ness* and living proof: SB pp. 137–138, 159. Seer, doer, and enjoyer together in awakened tradition; projection as living proof: KD 3.12, 3.18.
- **§1.6.4.** Supreme cause (*mahakaran*) in the sustaining sense: MVD pp. 288–289; SB pp. 49, 62. Time (*kaal*) as duration of unit-activity; timeless ground: see *Nature of Time* study.
- **§1.7.** Jeevan as constitutionally complete sentient atom; knower is jeevan, not body; knower as seer in seer–doer–enjoyer triad: MVD p. 115; SB pp. 91–92; KD 3.18. Five aspects in the jeevan-cloud: MVD p. 13. Orbital structure: "The nucleus of the sentient unit (a constitutionally complete atom) is referred to as atma. The particles in its first orbit are referred to as buddhi, those in the second orbit are referred to as chitta, those in the third orbit are referred to as vritti, and those in the fourth orbit are referred to as mun." (MVD, p. 78). Ten activities: JV p. 92. Projection–reflection (KD 3.12) and force/power as state–motion of the same faculties (KD 3.6) — not a second five-fold list. Sheaths (*annamaya, pranamaya/pran kosha, manomaya, anandamaya, vighyanmaya*): MVD pp. 49–50 (noted only to prevent conflation with faculties). Study circuit (reflection): "Affirmation of truth in the form of coexistence through the way of study is referred to as ratiocination in mun (in the form of acceptance), deliberation in vritti (by way of qualitative analysis), direct recognition in chitta, and enlightenment in buddhi." (MVD, p. 126); termination in *atma-bodh* and realisation: MVD pp. 286–287. Projection as evidencing cascade; knowledge unfolding (*gyan udghatan*): MVD pp. 99–100. "I" and "mine" on the delusional plane: MVD p. 78; body-as-self as root confusion: SB pp. 91–92. Animal-order narrow circuit: MVD p. 278. Four-and-a-half of ten activities; deliberation from pleasant/healthy/profitable only; believing severed from knowing: JV pp. 73–74. Three statuses of buddhi: MVD pp. 278–279.
- **§1.7.1.** Karma as activity together with aspiration; *karma* in the narrow sense as the doing (middle term of desire–karma–result); five limbs (doer, cause, objective, result, effect) as the structure of an intentional act for checking balance; balance of desire, karma, and result as

accomplishment of the desire: working English of KD Ch. 1 (printed pp. 1–2) — attributed paraphrase; verify against Hindi page images before quotation. Enactment / living proof: §§1.6.3, 1.16. Deluded vs awakened freedom in performing and undergoing action: “Deluded humans are independent when performing actions, but dependent when experiencing the consequences of those actions. Awakened humans are independent both in performing actions and in experiencing their consequences.” (MVD, p. 15); KD Ch. 1 parallel (working English).

- **§1.8.** Felt form of the happiness → bliss face of the completeness drive (§1.6). Jeevan values as harmonies: “Among the values, jeevan values are known by the names — happiness, peace, contentment and bliss, which are only names of the state of harmony within jeevan. Happiness is when there is harmony in mun and vritti, peace is when there is harmony in vritti and chitta, contentment is when there is harmony in chitta and buddhi, and bliss is when there is harmony in buddhi and atma.” (JV, p. 138). Four stages of happiness: “Happiness, peace, contentment and bliss - these are four stages of happiness.” (MVD, p. 163). Alignment with societal goals: JV p. 61 (§1.15). Effects of atma realised in truth on lower faculties: MVD p. 101. Channelling of energies: “The mode of channelling jeevan’s energies towards development (awakening) is through curiosity in mun, enthusiasm in vritti, delight in chitta, elation and immersion in buddhi, and finally, realisation in atma. For this, inward regulation of jeevan energies is essential.” (MVD, p. 77). Projection–reflection spiral (understand / make understood; widening evidence “today... one issue, tomorrow... two”): working English of KD 3.12 — attributed paraphrase; verify against Hindi before quotation. Human- and *jeevan*-aspiration meaningful together when projection is consistent: KD 3.12 (working English). Inward regulation; mediative atma disciplines faculties and body: MVD p. 277; nucleus/atma same structural role at two scales: MVD pp. 26, 78. Persistence: “Jeevan continues to exist even after death as it does while driving a body.” (JV, p. 20). Reassociation with another body is stated in JV, p. 54.
- **§1.9–1.9.1.** Four progressions — *niyati-kram*, *niyati-vidhi*, *vikas-kram*, *jagriti-kram*: MVD pp. 13–14 (first two named in *Paribhasha Samhita*). Pranic → animal junction — bodily basis from order chain, sentient unit from constitutional completeness: MVD pp. 8, 13, 91; SB pp. 76–77. Sentient-mode mapping of triad to goals: SB pp. 58, 71; projection/reflection toward resolution: SB pp. 60, 64–65, 69.
- **§1.9.2.** Plane (*pad*) as developmental standing; four planes; order–plane non-alignment: SB p. 52. Five human types (*pashu-manav*, *rakshas-manav*, discerning human, *dev-manav*, *divya-manav*): MVD p. 160. Human body as enabling medium with enriched nervous system and imagination: MVD p. 115; JV pp. 79, 93.
- **§1.10.** Inclination toward coexistence: “Everywhere, there exists a natural inclination towards coexistence. This inclination is what leads atomic particles to assemble into atoms, atoms to combine into molecules, and molecules to combine into molecular forms.” (JV, p. 67). Persist-or-decline: SB p. 14. Mixture (*mishran*) and compound (*yaugik*): MVD p. 42. Transmission of composition method (*rachna vidhi*) by constitution, seed, lineage, education-*sanskar*: JV pp. 48, 82; MVD pp. 92–93.
- **§1.11.** Self-regulating saturated units (*swatah-saspurt*); mediative (*madhyasth*) regulation: SB p. 57; MVD p. 26. “Regulation itself becomes clear in the form of law. Consequently, there is

provision in every unit for recognising one another based on law. This itself is the meaning of regulation.” (SB, p. 57). “Omnipotence is mediative, therefore the nature saturated in it is regulated and conserved. The nucleus within every atom is the mediative activity, whereby the atom’s generative-degenerative activities and relative powers are regulated and conserved.” (MVD, p. 26). Conformance modes per order (*niyati-vidhi*): §1.5 references; animal *adhyasa*: SB pp. 62–63. Justice as evaluative closure; statutory law (*dharma-niti, rajya-niti*) as separate codification: MVD p. 311 and the planned governance study.

- **§1.12.** Selection and taste-recognition in sentient nature: SB pp. 80–81; animal-order *jeevan* operates within hope-bound activity, while human evaluation is articulated through six perspectives. “All human behaviour is manifest in six perspectives: – (1) pleasant-unpleasant, (2) healthy-unhealthy, (3) profit-loss, (4) justice-injustice, (5) dharma-adharma, and (6) truth-untruth.” (MVD, p. 67). “The behaviour of humans with inhumane perspective is in the refuge of pleasant-unpleasant, healthy-unhealthy, and profit-loss. The behaviour of humans with humane perspective is in the refuge of justice-injustice, dharma-adharma, and truth-untruth.” (MVD, p. 67). Humane refuge reorganisation: MVD pp. 27, 67. Domain regulation: “The regulation of human behaviour takes place through justice, discipline in thoughts takes place through dharma, and realisation takes place only through truth.” (MVD, p. 137). Graduated chain: “The law itself is justice, justice itself is dharma, dharma itself is truth, truth itself is abundance (coexistence), realisation of abundance itself is bliss, bliss itself is jeevan, and law is in jeevan.” (MVD, p. 15); also MVD p. 162; KD *vikalp* / Ch. 1 parallel (working English). Hindi perspective terms: *priya–apriya, hita–ahita, labh–alabh, nyaya–anyaya, dharma–adharma, satya–asatya*.
- **§1.12.1.** “Recognising relationships, fulfilling values, evaluating, and achieving mutual satisfaction is justice.” (MVD, p. 311).
- **§1.13.** “The goal of development is for nature, saturated in Omnipotence, to be realised in Omnipotence. Realisation itself is the form of awakening. It is only through awakening that there is the orderliness of recognition and fulfilment. Recognition and fulfilment themselves constitute authenticity; this is the expression of realisation.” (SB, p. 81). Verity chain — “truth itself is abundance (coexistence), realisation of abundance itself is bliss, bliss itself is jeevan”: MVD pp. 14–15. Bliss evidenced in living: JV p. 61. KD distinguishes the roles: *jeevan* is knower and seer, existence-as-coexistence is the known and seen, and knowledge is the holistic view of coexistence, knowledge of *jeevan*, and knowledge of humane conduct (KD 3.17–3.18). The roles become harmonised in awakening without erasing their distinctions.
- **§1.14.** Coexistence conservation; no arising from non-being (*abhava*); world perpetual (*jagat satat*): “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.” (MVD, p. 13). Jeevan persistence: MVD p. 91; JV p. 20 (§§1.6.1, 1.8).
- **§1.15.** Four human goals — resolution (*samadhan*), prosperity (*samridhi*), fearlessness (*abhay*), coexistence (*saha-astitva*). Alignment with jeevan values (points to §1.8 table): “Resolution = Happiness. We realise happiness wherever we are resolved... Thereafter, we realise peace while evidencing resolution and prosperity in the family. We realise contentment by living orderly in society. We realise bliss in the course of evidencing our understanding.” (JV, p. 61). Undivided society (*akhand samaj*), universal orderliness (*sarvabhaum vyavastha*); five dimensions —

education-character (*shiksha-sanskar*), justice-preservation (*nyaya-suraksha*), health-restraint (*swasthya-sanyam*), production-work (*utpadan-karya*), exchange-storage (*vinimay-kosh*); humane tradition (*manav parampara*).

- **§1.16.** Summary table draws on the references above; lived verification through humane conduct (*pramanikta*) as final proof derived from karma’s enactment principle (§1.7.1): §§1.6.3, 1.7.1, 1.13 references.

Section 2

Verse and section numbers follow standard numbering and apply to any faithful edition (e.g. Swami Gambhirananda’s or Swami Madhavananda’s translations, Advaita Ashrama). Exact wording of every verse and passage paraphrased in §2’s body is preserved below, organised by subsection.

- **CU** — [*Chandogya Upanishad*](#). Cited: §§2.1–2.5, 2.9 (CU 6.2.1–6.2.2, Shankara commentary, 6.1.4, 6.8.7 with Śaṅkara’s bhāṣya).
- **TU** — [*Taittiriya Upanishad*](#). Cited: §2.2 (TU 2.1.1, 2.5).
- **MU** — [*Mandukya Upanishad*](#). Cited: §§2.3, 2.7 (MU, vv. 3–7).
- **BG** — [*Bhagavad Gita*](#), Shankara’s commentary (Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: §§2.7, 2.10 (BG 13.1–13.2, 3.8).
- **VC** — [*Vivekachudamani*](#) (attributed to Shankara). English translation by Swami Madhavananda. Cited: §§2.3–2.10 (vv. 217, 20, 216, 251, 244, 574, 393, 17–19).
- **DDV** — [*Drig-Drishya-Viveka*](#) (attributed to Shankara or Bharati Tirtha). Cited: §§2.7, 2.9 (vv. 1–5).
- **BS** — [*Brahma Sutra Bhashya*](#) (Shankara; Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: §2.9 (BS 1.1.2).
- **§2.1.** Foundational claim: “In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second.” (CU 6.2.1). Shankara’s gloss on *sat*: “mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness” (CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary). Rejection of origination from non-existence: “By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second.” (CU 6.2.2). *Nirguna* / *saguna* named as the absolute vs Ishvara pair; *Paramatman* sublated together with Ishvara and jiva: VC, v. 244 (quoted under §2.6 below).
- **§2.2.** Sat-Chit-Ananda: “Brahman is Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity.” (TU 2.1.1). Shankara on *satyam*: a thing is true when it does not change the nature ascertained as its own; *satyam brahma* distinguishes Brahman from mutable things (TU 2.1.1, Shankara’s commentary). On *jnanam*: knowledge as consciousness, not Brahman as agent of knowing (TU 2.1.1, Shankara’s commentary). On *anantam*: infinity as what is not delimited by time, space, or object (TU 2.1.1, Shankara’s commentary). *Anandamaya* sheath transcended in the Self beyond coverings (TU 2.5, Shankara’s commentary).
- **§2.3.** *Avastha-traya* and *turiya*: “The first quarter is Vaisvanara whose sphere (of action) is the waking state, whose consciousness relates to things external, who is possessed of seven limbs and nineteen mouths, and who enjoys gross things.” (MU, v. 3). “Taijasa is the second quarter,

whose sphere (of activity) is the dream state, whose consciousness is internal, who is possessed of seven limbs and nineteen mouths, and who enjoys subtle objects.” (MU, v. 4). “That state is deep sleep where the sleeper does not desire any enjoyable thing and does not see any dream. The third quarter is Prajna who has deep sleep as his sphere, in whom everything becomes undifferentiated, who is a mass of mere consciousness, who abounds in bliss, who is surely an enjoyer of bliss, and who is the doorway to the experience (of the dream and waking states).” (MU, v. 5). “They consider the Fourth to be that which is not conscious of the internal world, nor conscious of the external world, nor conscious of both the worlds, nor a mass of consciousness, nor conscious, nor unconscious; which is unseen, beyond empirical dealings, beyond the grasp (of the organs of action), uninferable, unthinkable, indescribable; whose valid proof consists in the single belief in the Self; in which all phenomena cease; and which is unchanging, auspicious, and non-dual. That is the Self, and That is to be known.” (MU, v. 7). Parallel VC formulation: “That which clearly manifests Itself in the states of wakefulness, dream and profound sleep; which is inwardly perceived in the mind in various forms as an unbroken series of egoistic impressions; which witnesses the egoism, the Buddhi, etc., which are of diverse forms and modifications; and which makes Itself felt as the Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute; know thou this Atman, thy own Self, within thy heart.” (VC, v. 217).

- **§2.4.** Discrimination: “A firm conviction of the mind to the effect that Brahman is real and the universe unreal, is designated as discrimination (Viveka) between the Real and the unreal.” (VC, v. 20). Identity of soul and Brahman: “The individual soul is itself and directly the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else.” (VC, v. 216). *Anirvacaniya* as a post-Shankara systematic term (Vimuktatman, Vivarana school); Shankara’s own usage is “neither *sat* nor *asat*” without that compound. Architecture figure placed after the three-tier table.
- **§2.5.** Maya/Avidya distinction: VC, vv. 243–244. Clay teaching: “My dear, as by the knowledge of one lump of clay alone all things made of clay are known — for all transformation has speech as its basis, it being name, while clay alone is real — so, my dear, is this knowledge.” (CU 6.1.4). Compressed restatement: “All modifications of clay, such as the jar, which are always accepted by the mind as real, are (in reality) nothing but clay. Similarly, this entire universe which is produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman Itself and nothing but That.” (VC, v. 251).
- **§2.6.** Ishvara/jiva superimposition: “These two are the superimpositions of Ishwara and the Jiva respectively, and when these are perfectly eliminated, there is neither Ishwara nor Jiva.” (VC, v. 244). *Nirguna* / *saguna*; reflection (*pratibimba*) and limitation (*avaccheda*) as classical accounts of apparent plurality; three bodies and *pancha kosha* as *upadhi* stack; karma/*samsara* as empirical continuity — owned for comparison with §§5.3.3 and 5.7. Sheath vocabulary shares Upanishadic terms with §§1.7, 1.9 without one-to-one match (§5.7.2).
- **§2.7.** Seer-seen discrimination: DDV, vv. 1–5. Field and knower: “This body, O son of Kunti, is called the field; he who knows it is called the knower of the field.” (BG 13.1); “Know also that I am the Knower of the field in all fields, and the knowledge of the field also am I.” (BG 13.2). *Turiya*: MU, vv. 3–7 (cross-ref §2.3).
- **§2.8.** Beginninglessness of Brahman: VC, v. 393. *Srishti–sthiti–laya* as beginningless empirical cycles. Fuller *trikaal* / *kaal* comparison in *Nature of Time*.

- **§2.9.** *Tat tvam asi*: CU 6.8.7, with Śāṅkara's bhāṣya; BS 1.1.2. Ultimate truth: "There is neither death nor birth, neither a bound nor a struggling soul, neither a seeker after Liberation nor a liberated one – this is the ultimate truth." (VC, v. 574). Nature of Brahman: "The Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless and changeless, devoid of interior or exterior, the One Existence, without a second, and one's own Self." (VC, v. 393). *Jivanmukti / videhamukti; adhyaropa-apavada; pramana* and the threefold path (*shravana, manana, nididhyasana*): classical Advaita epistemology, developed further in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#) §2. Ethical discipline as prerequisite to knowledge: VC, vv. 17–19.
- **§2.10.** *Loka-sangraha* and ordained duty: "Perform your bounden duty, for action is superior to inaction." (BG, 3.8; Shankara's commentary: *niyatam kuru karma*; the enlightened still act for the welfare of the world).
- **§2.11.** Summary table draws on the references above; no new sources cited.

Section 3

- **SB** — Nagraj, A. [Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad \(Resolution Centred Materialism\)](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Also at <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL69PCoz1OQW0dhshZ0Xv3KtZ7ajJOIpgv> (bilingual Hindi and English). Cited: §§3, 3.5 (pp. 48, 8, 44).
- **DDV** — [Drig-Drishya-Viveka](#) (attributed to Shankara or Bharati Tirtha). Cited: §3.2 (vv. 1–5).
- **Chalmers 1995** — Chalmers, D. "[Facing Up to the Problem of Consciousness.](#)" *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 2(3), 200–219. Also at <https://consc.net/papers/facing.pdf>. Cited: §3.2 (pp. 3).
- **Nagel 1974** — Nagel, T. "[What Is It Like to Be a Bat?](#)" *The Philosophical Review*, 83(4), 435–450. Also at https://www.cs.ox.ac.uk/activities/ieg/e-library/sources/nagel_bat.pdf. Cited: §3.2 (p. 1).
- **Strawson 2006** — Strawson, G. "[Realistic Monism: Why Physicalism Entails Panpsychism.](#)" *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 13(10–11), 3–31. Also at <https://consc.net/event/reef/strawsonmonism.pdf>. Cited: §§3.1, 3.3 (pp. 2, 12).
- **Kim 2005** — Kim, J. [Physicalism, or Something Near Enough](#). Princeton University Press. Cited: §3.1 (causal closure).
- **Frankish 2016** — Frankish, K. "[Illusionism as a Theory of Consciousness.](#)" *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 23(11–12), 11–39. Cited: §3.3 (pp. 1, 8).
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- **SEP Personal Identity** — Olson, E. [“Personal Identity.”](#) *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*. Cited: §3.4.
- **SEP Form and Matter** — Robinson, H. [“Hylomorphism.”](#) *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*. Cited: §3.6.1.
- **Aquinas ST** — Aquinas, T. [Summa Theologiae I, qq. 75–76](#). Cited: §3.6.1 (*anima forma corporis*).
- **Spinoza Ethics** — Spinoza, B. [Ethics](#), trans. R. H. M. Elwes. Cited: §3.6.2 (Part I, Props. 14–15; Part II, Def. 3).
- **Leibniz Monadology** — Leibniz, G. W. [Monadology](#), trans. R. Latta. Cited: §3.6.3 (§§1–14, 78–81).
- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. [Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §3.6.3 (p. 13).
- **Whitehead 1929** — Whitehead, A. N. [Process and Reality](#) (1929 ed.). Cited: §3.6.4 (pp. 28, 44).
- **Russell 1921** — Russell, B. [The Analysis of Mind](#). Cited: §3.6.5 (Lecture I).
- **Mach 1914** — Mach, E. [The Analysis of Sensations](#), trans. C. M. Williams and S. Waterlow. Cited: §3.6.5 (Ch. XIV).

Section 4

- **SB** — Nagraj, A. [Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad \(Resolution Centred Materialism\)](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Also at <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL69PCoz1OQW0dhshZ0Xv3KtZ7ajJOIpgv> (bilingual Hindi and English). Cited: §§4, 4.5–4.6 (pp. 44, 65, 251).
- **JV** — Nagraj, A. [Jeevan Vidya: An Introduction](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §§4, 4.6 (pp. 59, 77).
- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. [Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §§4.5–4.6 (pp. 34, 195, 56–57, 324).
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Section 5

- **VC** — [Vivekachudamani](#) (attributed to Shankara). English translation by Swami Madhavananda. Cited: §§5.1–5.7 (vv. 574, 244, 251, 20, 210, 639).
- **CU** — [Chandogya Upanishad](#). Cited: §§5.5, 5.7 (6.8.7; 6.2.1–6.2.2 with Śaṅkara’s bhāṣya).
- **BS** — [Brahma Sutra Bhashya](#) (Shankara; Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: §§5.7.3, 5.7.5 (BS 1.1.2, 2.1.14 with Śaṅkara’s bhāṣya).
- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. [Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §§5.3.2, 5.3.5, 5.7 (pp. 13, 88, 115, 12, 49–50).
- **SB** — Nagraj, A. [Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad \(Resolution Centred Materialism\)](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Also at <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL69PCoz1OQW0dhshZ0Xv3KtZ7ajJOIpgv> (bilingual Hindi and English). Cited: §§5.3.5, 5.7.5 (pp. 44, 57, 62, 69, 62–63).
- **Friston 2010** — Friston, K. [“The free-energy principle: a unified brain theory?”](#) *Nature Reviews Neuroscience*, 11(2), 127–138. Cited: §5.5 (entity table, ultimate purpose row).

Section 6

- **SB** — Nagraj, A. [Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad \(Resolution Centred Materialism\)](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Also at <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL69PCoz1OQW0dhshZ0Xv3KtZ7ajJOIpgv> (bilingual Hindi and English). Cited: §§6.2.1–6.2.3 (pp. 44, 55, 59, 91–92, 114).
- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. [Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §§6.2.1–6.2.3, 6.3 (*The Alternative*; pp. 88, 91, 115, 288–289).

- **JV** — Nagraj, A. [*Jeevan Vidya: An Introduction*](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: §6.2.2 (pp. 20, 54).
- **Strawson 2006** — Strawson, G. [*“Realistic Monism: Why Physicalism Entails Panpsychism.”*](#) *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 13(10–11), 3–31. Also at <https://consc.net/event/reef/strawsonmonism.pdf>. Cited: §6.4 (panpsychist physicalism as a non-reductive modern alternative).
- **CU** — [*Chandogya Upanishad*](#). Cited: §6.3 (CU 6.2.2).
- **DDV** — [*Drig-Drishya-Viveka*](#) (attributed to Shankara or Bharati Tirtha). Cited: §6.3 (seer-seen discrimination).
- **MU** — [*Mandukya Upanishad*](#). Cited: §6.3 (three-state analysis).
- **VC** — [*Vivekachudamani*](#) (attributed to Shankara). English translation by Swami Madhavananda. Cited: §6.3 (v. 251).
- **Chalmers 1995** — Chalmers, D. [*“Facing Up to the Problem of Consciousness.”*](#) *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 2(3), 200–219. Also at <https://consc.net/papers/facing.pdf>. Cited: §6.4.
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Section 7

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